



# **Evidence-based frameworks for Digital, Data, Innovation and Artificial Intelligence (DDAI) upskilling in the UK Civil Service**

Skills and Capabilities Framework

Draft for approval

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# What the framework is

The skills non-specialist civil servants need across digital, data, innovation and AI.

The framework has been developed by drawing on national and international frameworks, applied evidence and extensive engagement with Civil Service stakeholders.

You use it to understand your current capability and to identify where you want to develop. It is a maturity framework: it describes what strong performance looks like at each stage, not a minimum standard to pass.

## The four domains

|                                                                                                                 |                                                                                 |                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Digital</b></p> <p>Confident, safe and purposeful use of technology and leadership of digital change.</p> | <p><b>Data</b></p> <p>Evidence-based decision-making through data literacy.</p> | <p><b>Innovation</b></p> <p>User-centred, experimental and systems thinking skills, enabling continuous improvement.</p> | <p><b>AI</b></p> <p>Understanding, applying and governing AI systems responsibly and sustainably.</p> |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## How it is structured

Each domain contains clusters of related capability. Each cluster is divided into strands, and each strand contains the questions you assess yourself against.

## What you assess

You assess only the parts that apply to your grade and role. Every question is written across five levels of proficiency and is tagged as Knowledge, Skills or Behaviours.

# Framework overview

Four domains, fourteen clusters and twenty-eight strands.

| Digital                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Data                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Innovation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | AI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Foundational Digital Skills</b><br/>Using digital tools effectively<br/>Choosing the right digital tools<br/>Creating accessible digital content</div> <div><b>Responsible Information Practices</b><br/>Handling information accurately and responsibly</div> <div><b>Digital Transformation</b><br/>Focusing on users<br/>Making digital services work for everyone</div> <div><b>Digital Leadership</b><br/>Leading in a digital age</div> | <div><b>Foundational Data Skills</b><br/>Data literacy<br/>Interpreting visual data<br/>Managing data lifecycles</div> <div><b>Data Quality and Integrity</b><br/>Ensuring data quality<br/>Handling data ethically and lawfully<br/>Applying data standards</div> <div><b>Data-Driven Decision Making</b><br/>Analysing data</div> <div><b>Responsible Data Sharing</b><br/>Collaborating with data</div> | <div><b>Conditions for Innovation</b><br/>Psychological safety and adaptability</div> <div><b>Understanding the Problem</b><br/>Identifying innovation opportunities</div> <div><b>Doing the Work</b><br/>Using the innovation lifecycle<br/>Testing and prototyping<br/>Storytelling and advocacy</div> <div><b>Making Change Stick</b><br/>Continuous improvement<br/>Embedding innovation at scale</div> | <div><b>Foundational AI Skills</b><br/>AI literacy<br/>Assessing AI opportunities<br/>Using AI safely</div> <div><b>AI Governance and Ethics</b><br/>Interpreting AI outputs<br/>Applying AI governance<br/>Using AI responsibly and ethically</div> |

## Transversal capabilities

Five cross-cutting ways of working tagged across the framework. They are not a fifth domain.

- Systems Thinking
- Digital Wellbeing
- Ethical Practice
- Collaborative Working
- Continuous Learning

# Digital

Confident, safe and purposeful use of technology and leadership of digital change. 4 clusters, 7 strands.

| Foundational Digital Skills                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Responsible Information Practices                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Digital Transformation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Digital Leadership                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Using digital tools effectively</b><br/>Uses the software, platforms and online tools needed for modern workplace tasks — including communicating, collaborating, managing information and working securely — with confidence and good judgement in any work setting.</div> <div><b>Choosing the right digital tools</b><br/>Selects the right tool for the task — from everyday choices about how to share or collaborate on a piece of work, through to contributing to team standards and organisational procurement decisions.</div> <div><b>Creating accessible digital content</b><br/>Creates and shares digital content and communications that everyone can use, applying accessibility standards and meeting legal requirements to support clear, user-friendly digital experiences for all.</div> | <div><b>Handling information accurately and responsibly</b><br/>Ensures the information you work with is accurate, current and well-managed — knowing where it came from, keeping it appropriately organised and protected, and disposing of it correctly when it is no longer needed.</div> | <div><b>Focusing on users</b><br/>Understands the needs of the people your work affects and uses that understanding to improve how services and processes are designed and delivered.</div> <div><b>Making digital services work for everyone</b><br/>Ensures digital public services work for everyone who needs them, reflecting the diverse needs, backgrounds and circumstances of all users and applying government guidance on inclusive design.</div> | <div><b>Leading in a digital age</b><br/>Shapes how your team uses technology to work better and deliver more — championing digital, data and AI approaches, managing change confidently and building the capability and confidence of others.</div> |

# Data

Evidence-based decision-making through data literacy. 4 clusters, 8 strands.

| Foundational Data Skills                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Data Quality and Integrity                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Data-Driven Decision Making                                                                                                                                                    | Responsible Data Sharing                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>Data literacy</b><br/>Builds the foundational understanding, skills and behaviours needed to work confidently and responsibly with data, recognising that evidence-based decisions lead to better outcomes.</div> <div><b>Interpreting visual data</b><br/>Reads charts, graphs and other visual representations of data to extract meaning, identify patterns and support clear communication of evidence.</div> <div><b>Managing data lifecycles</b><br/>Handles data responsibly through each stage of its lifecycle — from collection and storage through to sharing, retention and disposal — following good practice to keep data secure, accurate and useful.</div> | <div><b>Ensuring data quality</b><br/>Reviews and improves data to ensure they are accurate, representative and fit for purpose, helping teams to make reliable decisions and maintain trust in information.</div> <div><b>Handling data ethically and lawfully</b><br/>Collects, uses and shares data fairly, securely and in line with laws and ethical principles, recognising that legal compliance is the minimum standard and that ethical obligations go further.</div> <div><b>Applying data standards</b><br/>Uses agreed rules and formats to keep data consistent and interoperable, supporting effective data use, openness and collaboration across the Civil Service.</div> | <div><b>Analysing data</b><br/>Uses data and analytical tools and techniques to find patterns, draw insights and support evidence-based decisions that improve outcomes.</div> | <div><b>Collaborating with data</b><br/>Works with other teams and organisations to share and reuse data safely and ethically, helping to create collaborative insight, efficiency and improvement.</div> |



# Innovation

User-centred, experimental and systems thinking skills, enabling continuous improvement. 4 clusters, 7 strands.

| Conditions for Innovation                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Understanding the Problem                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Doing the Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Making Change Stick                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Psychological safety and adaptability</b></p> <p>Creates the conditions for colleagues to share ideas, try new approaches and learn from failure, building a team environment where experimentation and honest reflection are normal.</p> | <p><b>Identifying innovation opportunities</b></p> <p>Spots where innovation is most likely to make a real difference, using evidence and user insight to distinguish genuine opportunities from novelty for its own sake.</p> | <p><b>Using the innovation lifecycle</b></p> <p>Applies the stages of the innovation lifecycle — from identifying a problem through to testing, refining and deciding whether to scale, stop or adapt — with appropriate rigour at each stage.</p> <p><b>Testing and prototyping</b></p> <p>Tries out ideas on a small scale first, using prototypes, pilots and minimum viable products to learn quickly and reduce risk before committing to larger investment.</p> <p><b>Storytelling and advocacy</b></p> <p>Communicates ideas for change in a way that genuinely persuades different audiences, framing evidence and impact so that decision-makers, colleagues and users understand why it matters.</p> | <p><b>Continuous improvement</b></p> <p>Treats improvement as an ongoing habit, regularly reviewing how work is done and making evidence-based changes to processes, services and outcomes.</p> <p><b>Embedding innovation at scale</b></p> <p>Supports the adoption and spread of new approaches beyond a pilot or team, sustaining commitment and adapting what worked locally so it works more widely.</p> |

# AI

Understanding, applying and governing AI systems responsibly and sustainably. 2 clusters, 6 strands.

| Foundational AI Skills                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | AI Governance and Ethics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>AI literacy</b><br/>Builds foundational understanding of what AI is, how it works and what it can and cannot do across machine learning, automation and generative AI, and develops the practical skills needed to specify inputs, use tools effectively and work critically with outputs in everyday work.</div> <div><b>Assessing AI opportunities</b><br/>Identifies where AI and automation could add genuine value, and recognises the limitations and risks that could make AI unsuitable.</div> <div><b>Using AI safely</b><br/>Uses AI tools and automation safely in everyday work — knowing which tools are approved, what data can be shared with them, spotting when a prompt or task carries risk, and escalating when something feels wrong.</div> | <div><b>Interpreting AI outputs</b><br/>Develops the skills and behaviours needed to check, interpret and communicate AI outputs critically and honestly — maintaining human judgment and transparency rather than deferring uncritically to AI recommendations.</div> <div><b>Applying AI governance</b><br/>Understands and applies the legal, regulatory and compliance frameworks that govern AI use in public services — including identifying and responding to governance risks.</div> <div><b>Using AI responsibly and ethically</b><br/>Applies ethical principles to AI use in public services — including fairness, transparency to citizens, public benefit and consideration of wider societal and environmental impact — grounded in the Data and AI Ethics Framework and UK AI regulatory principles.</div> |



# Proficiency levels

Every question is written across five levels, from Novice to Expert.

|                                                                                            |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>1</div> <div>Novice</div> <div>You are new to this capability and need support.</div> | <div>2</div> <div>Awareness</div> <div>You understand the basics and can use them with support.</div> | <div>3</div> <div>Working</div> <div>You can apply the capability independently in your everyday work.</div> | <div>4</div> <div>Practitioner</div> <div>You can apply it in more complex situations and support others.</div> | <div>5</div> <div>Expert</div> <div>You lead or shape practice, standards or capability more widely.</div> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### These levels describe maturity, not a pass mark.

Your target level depends on your role and the capability being assessed. You are not expected to reach Expert in every capability. For most people, Working is a strong and appropriate target on the capabilities they use every day.

## Two ways to demonstrate maturity

At Practitioner and Expert the same level can be reached in two valid ways. You do not need both on every strand.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Specialist depth</div> <div>Authoritative knowledge and expert skills in domain strands — from the experienced colleague others rely on at Practitioner through to heads of profession at Expert.</div> | <div>Enabling leadership</div> <div>Strong transversal practice — coaching, psychological safety, ethical judgement, collaboration and learning from failure. Working–Practitioner knowledge is enough where your job is to commission, challenge well and support experts.</div> | <div>Mixed remit</div> <div>Both patterns apply — for example a G6 profession lead who sets standards in their domain and shapes team culture.</div> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

# Proficiency reference

Each capability is described in three ways, and each is written across the five levels.

| Level          | Knowledge<br>What you understand — concepts, principles and why they matter.                                                                              | Skills<br>What you can apply — practice in real tasks and situations.                                                            | Behaviours<br>How you act — habits, judgement and influence visible to others.                                                    | Typical roles<br>Where the level is usually seen. Indicative, not a rule.                                                                                              |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Novice       | Has little or no practical knowledge yet. Can name the topic in broad terms and is beginning to see why it might matter.                                  | Cannot apply the capability reliably without direct support. May try with close guidance and makes exploratory first attempts.   | Shows curiosity and motivation to learn. Asks questions and is open to feedback without defensiveness.                            | New starters; apprentices; colleagues new to digital, data, AI or innovation in their role; those returning after a long gap.                                          |
| 2 Awareness    | Understands what the capability is and why it matters. Can recognise it in use and describe its importance in simple terms.                               | Uses basic elements with support. Identifies simple opportunities where it could improve clarity, efficiency or service quality. | Engages when encouraged. Tries new approaches with support and reflects on what worked.                                           | Operational delivery roles building foundation; administrators and caseworkers establishing reliable everyday practice.                                                |
| 3 Working      | Understands core concepts and methods. Has reliable knowledge and can explain benefits in the context of their own work.                                  | Applies the capability independently in routine tasks. Adapts straightforward approaches to local needs with minimal guidance.   | Demonstrates the capability consistently in everyday work. Takes responsibility for own development and follows agreed standards. | Policy officers, analysts, delivery staff and operations managers using the capability routinely; the benchmark for competent performance in most civil service roles. |
| 4 Practitioner | Has detailed understanding including nuances and implications for quality and outcomes. Shares knowledge proactively with colleagues.                     | Uses the capability independently across varied scenarios. Troubleshoots complex issues and improves local practice.             | Coaches and supports others informally. Models good practice and helps colleagues apply standards consistently.                   | Where informal influence begins — experienced specialists others rely on, and team coordinators or workstream leads who improve practice around them.                  |
| 5 Expert       | Holds authoritative expertise with insight into strategic value and system-level implications. Recognised as a trusted source of guidance in your domain. | Leads application across teams or services. Influences standards, governance or practice and drives improvement at scale.        | Shapes culture and expectations. Champions responsible practice and develops capability in others systematically.                 | Heads of profession, lead specialists, programme and function directors, G6+ leaders with authority to set direction, and cross-government leads.                      |

# Transversal capabilities

Five ways of working that appear across digital, data, innovation and AI. They are not a fifth domain.

## How they are used

Related questions in the framework are marked as being indicators of application of transversal capabilities. So as well as looking at capability in each domain, the framework also looks at cross-cutting skills.

## Where they show up

They are not assessed separately and carry no proficiency levels of their own. They are tagged on the questions that evidence them, so your profile shows both domain capability and the ways of working that run through it.

| Capability            | Focus                                       | Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Systems Thinking      | Analytical and critical thinking            | Analyses how digital, data and AI systems and tools affect people, policies and institutions. Questions problems, interprets data critically, spots unintended impacts and chooses options that improve outcomes, not just add tech. |
| Digital Wellbeing     | Supportive culture and psychological safety | Creates safe, inclusive spaces for colleagues and citizens to engage with digital change. Shows empathy, communicates clearly, addresss fears openly and models emotionally intelligent behaviours.                                  |
| Ethical Practice      | Trust, accountability and user focus        | Makes responsible digital and AI decisions that protect rights and build public trust. Anticipates risks, designs around user needs and ensures fairness and safety while delivering value.                                          |
| Collaborative Working | Teamwork and inclusivity                    | Brings together diverse perspectives to deliver joined-up digital services. Shares information, co-creates with users and coordinates work for benefits across the whole system.                                                     |
| Continuous Learning   | Reflection & curiosity                      | Stays curious, experiments with new tools, reflects on outcomes, seeks feedback and refines practices to keep improving performance and service quality.                                                                             |

# Roles and grades

You assess yourself against the parts of the framework that fit your role.

The questions relevant to you depend on your grade and the responsibilities of your role. Each question is marked to show which grades it applies to, so you only work through the parts that fit.

Your grade also indicates the proficiency level that would normally be relevant. This does not mean everyone at the same grade should reach the same level in every capability — different roles need different depth.

### The level that fits the role

A higher level is not automatically the goal. For some capabilities Awareness or Working is the right level for your role; others may call for Practitioner or Expert.

## How many questions apply at each grade

| Grade | Digital | Data | Innovation | AI | Total | Proportion of the framework |
|-------|---------|------|------------|----|-------|-----------------------------|
| AA/AO | 6       | 16   | —          | 10 | 32    | <div><div></div></div>      |
| EO    | 9       | 17   | 5          | 10 | 41    | <div><div></div></div>      |
| HEO   | 15      | 32   | 16         | 10 | 73    | <div><div></div></div>      |
| SEO   | 15      | 32   | 22         | 22 | 91    | <div><div></div></div>      |
| G7    | 18      | 32   | 23         | 22 | 95    | <div><div></div></div>      |
| G6    | 18      | 32   | 23         | 22 | 95    | <div><div></div></div>      |
| SCS   | 18      | 32   | 23         | 22 | 95    | <div><div></div></div>      |

# How to read the framework

Each question carries three pieces of information alongside its five descriptors.

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Grade applicability     | <div>Applies to</div> <div><div>AA/AO</div><div>EO</div><div>HEO</div><div>SEO</div><div>G7</div><div>G6</div><div>SCS</div></div> <div>Which grades assess themselves against this question. Solid grades apply; greyed grades do not. In this example the question applies from HEO upward.</div> |
| Question type           | <div><div>Knowledge</div><div>Skills</div><div>Behaviours</div></div> <div>Whether the question assesses what you understand, what you can apply, or how you act. Shown as a shaded badge on every question.</div>                                                                                  |
| Transversal tags        | <div><div>Systems Thinking</div><div>Digital Wellbeing</div><div>Ethical Practice</div><div>Collaborative Working</div><div>Continuous Learning</div></div> <div>Any cross-cutting capability the question also evidences, shown as an outlined badge. Not every question carries one.</div>        |
| Proficiency descriptors | <div>Five columns describing what performance looks like at each level for that question, read left to right from Novice to Expert. Find the description that best matches your current practice.</div>                                                                                             |

# The framework

## Digital domain

Working effectively in a digital workplace — digital tools, accessible digital content, user-centred digital services, leading in a digital age and handling information well.

### Using digital tools effectively 2 questions

Foundational Digital Skills

Uses the software, platforms and online tools needed for modern workplace tasks - including communicating, collaborating, managing information and working securely - with confidence and good judgement in any work setting.

Skills

Continuous Learning

How would you rate your competence in using digital tools and software to complete everyday tasks?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Follows instructions to use simple digital tools for everyday tasks such as logging in, finding basic information or joining an online meeting. Needs help when problems occur but shows curiosity and asks questions to learn. | Uses common digital tools with support to complete basic tasks such as editing a shared document or updating an online task list. Recognises how digital tools help teams stay connected and asks for help when unsure. | Applies digital tools independently to complete routine tasks such as joining online meetings, sharing documents and tracking progress. Applies agreed ways of working and fixes simple issues to keep work running smoothly. | Organises and independently manages work across multiple digital tools and platforms. Sets up shared spaces, keeps information easy to find and models good online practice. Solves most everyday digital issues and supports colleagues. | Leads on identifying how digital tools and platforms should be best used within the team. Designs simple, consistent ways of working online, promotes secure and inclusive use, and drives improvements that make work quicker and clearer. |



Digital domain

|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                              |
| How would you rate your competence in managing and organising information and files so they are easy to find, appropriately shared and kept secure? |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                    | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                           |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                            | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                            | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                     | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                     |
| Follows instructions to save and find files in shared spaces but needs support to organise information or apply security settings.                  | Uses basic file management steps with guidance - saves documents in the right place, follows naming conventions and checks sharing permissions before sending. | Keeps information well-organised and easy to find across shared spaces. Applies agreed security and sharing practices consistently and helps colleagues do the same. | Reviews and improves how information is organised and shared across a team. Identifies risks and inconsistencies and puts in place clearer structures or guidance. | Sets standards for how information is managed, organised and secured across teams. Ensures practices are consistent, secure and easy for everyone to follow. |

Choosing the right digital tools1 question

Foundational Digital Skills

Selects the right tool for the task - from everyday choices about how to share or collaborate on a piece of work, through to contributing to team standards and organisational procurement decisions.

|                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div>                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| How would you rate your competence in deciding which tool or method best fits the task at hand?                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                               |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Follows instructions about which tool to use for a task but needs support to understand why one option might suit better than another. | Recognises that different tools suit different purposes and asks for guidance when unsure which to use. Begins to make simple choices independently, such as whether to email a document or share it in a collaborative space. | Makes routine tool choices independently and with confidence - selecting the right platform, format or method for the task. Explains choices simply to colleagues and adapts when a chosen tool isn't working well. | Helps teams develop consistent, well-reasoned approaches to tool selection. Contributes to more formal requirements-gathering and advises colleagues on choices that balance user needs, security and organisational standards. | Sets team standards for tool selection and promotes evidence-based, consistent practice. Contributes to procurement and organisational buying decisions, ensuring choices reflect user needs, value for money and long-term fit. |

Digital domain

Creating accessible digital content 3 questions

Foundational Digital Skills

Creates and shares digital content and communications that everyone can use, applying accessibility standards and meeting legal requirements to support clear, user-friendly digital experiences for all.

Knowledge

Ethical Practice

How would you rate your understanding of accessibility standards and legal requirements for digital content, and what they mean in practice?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                                   | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                    | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Has little knowledge of accessibility standards or legal requirements but begins to notice when content might be hard for some people to use and shows curiosity about how to improve it. | Understands what accessibility standards are, why they exist and what the key legal requirements mean for everyday content creation. | Understands core accessibility principles and methods, including how standards apply across different content types, formats and platforms. | Has detailed knowledge of accessibility standards and legal requirements, including how they apply across varied tools, platforms and user needs. | Holds authoritative knowledge of accessibility standards, legal frameworks and emerging good practice, and understands their strategic implications for organisations. |

Skills

Ethical Practice

How would you rate your competence in creating and checking digital content so it meets accessibility standards and works for people with different needs?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                          | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                            | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Follows clear instructions to create or edit simple digital content. Begins to notice when something might be hard to read or use and asks questions about how to make it easier. | Uses basic accessibility steps with guidance such as adding alt text, using clear headings or checking colour contrast. Seeks help when unsure how to meet accessibility requirements. | Applies accessibility principles in routine work, creating and editing content that meets departmental standards. Uses clear language, structured layouts and accessible formats. Makes simple improvements when issues are found. | Plans and delivers digital content that meets accessibility standards across different tools and platforms. Considers varied user needs, devices and assistive technologies when designing or reviewing content. | Leads accessible digital practice within individual teams. Sets and maintains best-practice efforts including training, ensures all content meets legal requirements, and reviews major projects for compliance and quality. |



Digital domain

|                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| How would you rate your competence in supporting good accessibility practice beyond your own work - whether by modelling it, helping colleagues or flagging where standards aren't being met? |                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                              | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                          | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Begins to notice when colleagues produce content that might not work for everyone and asks questions about how to raise it.                                                                   | Raises observations about accessibility in team discussions and shares simple tips or guidance with colleagues when opportunities arise. | Actively supports colleagues to meet accessibility standards. Shares examples of good practice, flags issues constructively and helps others understand why accessibility matters. | Leads on embedding accessible content practice across projects. Coaches colleagues, reviews others' work for accessibility and makes the case for prioritising it when it is deprioritised under delivery pressure. | Promotes a culture where accessibility is a default expectation. Ensures it is built into training, ways of working and major decisions, and holds teams accountable for meeting legal standards. |

Handling information accurately and responsibly2 questions

Responsible Information Practices

Ensures the information you work with is accurate, current and well-managed - knowing where it came from, keeping it appropriately organised and protected, and disposing of it correctly when it is no longer needed.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div>                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| How would you rate your competence in checking that the information you work with and share is accurate, current and from a reliable source?                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Follows instructions to check simple information such as confirming where it came from or when it was last updated. Begins to notice when something looks wrong or out of date and asks for help to correct it. | Uses basic checks to confirm that information is accurate and current, such as checking the source, looking for a version number or asking whether guidance has been updated. Recognises when information looks unreliable and reports it to others. | Applies routine checks to keep information accurate and trustworthy. Verifies sources, identifies the authoritative version, corrects errors within their area of work and flags issues when information looks inconsistent or out of date. | Reviews how information is sourced, verified and maintained across projects. Identifies patterns of inaccuracy or unreliability, makes improvements and coaches colleagues to apply consistent checks. Ensures information used in decisions is traceable and well evidenced. | Sets standards for how information accuracy and reliability are maintained across teams. Ensures version control, provenance and currency are built into ways of working. Reviews major work to confirm information is well governed and promotes a culture of critical, evidence-based information use. |

Digital domain

| <div>SkillsCollaborative Working</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in organising, classifying and managing information and files so they are easy to find, appropriately protected and correctly disposed of when no longer needed?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEOG7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Follows instructions to save files in the right place and begins to notice why organising information carefully matters. Needs support to understand classification or access settings.                                                                                                         | Saves documents in agreed locations, follows basic naming conventions and applies simple access or security settings with guidance. Understands that different information needs different levels of protection and asks for help when unsure. | Organises and maintains files and shared spaces so information is easy to find and consistently structured. Applies correct classification and access controls, follows agreed retention and disposal processes and helps colleagues do the same. | Reviews and improves how information is organised, classified and managed across projects. Identifies risks such as incorrect classification, oversharing or information being retained longer than necessary. Coaches colleagues and ensures practices meet organisational standards. | Sets standards for how information is organised, classified, protected and disposed of across teams. Ensures classification, access control and retention policies are practical, consistently applied and built into team ways of working. Reviews major work to confirm information is well governed throughout its lifecycle. |

Focusing on users3 questions

Digital Transformation

Understands the needs of the people your work affects and uses that understanding to improve how services and processes are designed and delivered.

| <div>Knowledge</div> <div>How would you rate your understanding of user-centred principles and why understanding user needs matters for the work you do?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEOG7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                 | 3 Working                                                                                                                         | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                  | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                             |
| Has little knowledge of user-centred principles but begins to notice when something is hard to use and shows curiosity about why that matters.                                                           | Understands the basic idea that services should be designed around the needs of the people who use them, and can explain why this leads to better outcomes. | Understands core user-centred principles and methods, including how research and testing feed into design and delivery decisions. | Has detailed understanding of user-centred practice, including how to apply it across complex or multi-team projects and how to make the case for it to others. | Holds authoritative knowledge of user-centred principles and their strategic value, including how they connect to policy, delivery and public trust. |

Digital domain

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| <div>SkillsCollaborative WorkingContinuous Learning</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in finding out what users need - and using that insight to improve your work or processes?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                               | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                               | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Follows instructions to help gather simple feedback or observations but needs support to understand what to do with them.                                                                                                                     | Helps collect feedback and takes part in simple research or testing activities. Shares observations with colleagues and recognises patterns in what users find difficult. | Applies straightforward methods to gather and interpret user feedback. Shares insights with design or delivery colleagues and contributes to decisions about how to improve services. | Plans and runs research and testing activities, ensuring findings inform design and delivery. Coaches colleagues to apply user-centred methods consistently across projects. | Ensures research, testing and feedback are embedded in design and delivery processes across teams. Works with leaders to sustain a culture of continuous improvement in user experience. |

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>BehavioursEthical PracticeSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate your ability to keep user needs in view when other priorities or pressures are pulling in a different direction?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                                                                      | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                         | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Begins to notice when something doesn't seem to work well for users and asks questions about why decisions were made that way.                                                                                                                  | Raises observations about user needs in team discussions and supports colleagues in considering the impact of decisions on users. | Speaks up when user needs risk being overlooked in delivery decisions. Uses evidence from research or feedback to support their point of view. | Actively challenges decisions that deprioritise user needs and helps teams find ways to balance delivery pressures with user outcomes. | Models and promotes a culture where user needs are treated as non-negotiable. Supports leaders to make decisions that maintain public trust and service quality under pressure. |

Digital domain

Making digital services work for everyone 4 questions

Digital Transformation

Ensures digital public services work for everyone who needs them, reflecting the diverse needs, backgrounds and circumstances of all users and applying government guidance on inclusive design.

|                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Knowledge</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <div>How would you rate your understanding of what inclusive design means for digital work and services, and what government guidance says about designing for everyone?</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <div>Applies to</div> <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                       | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                        | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                   | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Has little knowledge of inclusive design principles but begins to notice when something might not work for certain users and asks questions about how to make it fairer.       | Understands what inclusive design means and why it matters - that services should work for everyone, including people who face barriers due to circumstances, disability, language or confidence. | Understands core inclusive design principles and how government guidance applies them in practice, including what makes services hard to access for some people. | Has detailed knowledge of inclusive design requirements, including legal duties, good practice guidance and how to apply them across complex or multi-team work. | Holds authoritative knowledge of inclusive design principles, legal frameworks and emerging practice; understands their strategic implications for public service delivery. |

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <div>How would you rate your competence in finding out about the different needs, backgrounds and circumstances of the people your work affects?</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <div>Applies to</div> <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                          |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Follows instructions to help create or test content for different users but needs support to understand what makes something inclusive or exclusive.   | Uses basic inclusive design steps with guidance, such as checking that language, images or layouts work for different users. Identifies simple ways to make things clearer or more welcoming. | Applies inclusive design principles in routine work; engages with different user groups, adapts approaches based on feedback and uses government guidance to make services easier to use for people with varied backgrounds and needs. | Plans and runs user research and engagement that includes people with varied backgrounds and experiences. Reviews services to check they reflect diverse user needs and leads on adopting inclusive design principles across work. | Sets the direction for inclusive digital design across teams. Ensures inclusivity is built into training and ways of working, and reviews major work to confirm it reflects the needs of all users - including those hardest to reach. |

Digital domain

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Continuous Learning</div>                                  |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                            |
| How would you rate your competence in using what you learn about users to shape or change your work?          |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                            |
|                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                     | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>         |                                                                                                                                            |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                  | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                   |
| Does not yet adapt work based on user feedback independently. Follows instructions to make suggested changes. | Makes small changes to content or processes based on feedback or observations about what users find difficult. | Applies what is learned from users to improve work. Tests changes, checks whether they help and iterates based on further feedback. | Leads improvement work based on user insight across a team; ensures changes are tested, evaluated and embedded. | Shapes how user insight drives continuous improvement across teams; ensures learning from diverse users is built into how services evolve. |

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| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div> <div>Digital Wellbeing</div>                                                      |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| How would you rate your ability to ensure the needs of people who are harder to reach or more likely to be excluded are considered in your work from the start? |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                   | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                   | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                                        | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                         | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                            | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Begins to notice when something might not work for certain users and asks questions about how to make it fairer or easier to use.                               | Raises concerns when something seems likely to exclude certain users and looks for ways to make it more welcoming. | Consistently applies an inclusive mindset in everyday work - questioning assumptions, sharing examples of good practice and encouraging others to consider who might be left out. | Leads by example on inclusive practice. Coaches colleagues to consider diverse user needs from the start and challenges approaches that risk excluding people. Reviews work to identify and address gaps. | Promotes a culture where inclusive thinking is a default expectation. Sets the standard for how teams consider excluded and harder-to-reach users and ensures this is built into training, ways of working and major decisions. |

Digital domain

Leading in a digital age 3 questions

Digital Leadership

Shapes how your team uses technology to work better and deliver more - championing digital, data and AI approaches, managing change confidently and building the capability and confidence of others.

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| How would you rate your understanding of how digital, data and AI can transform the way teams work and deliver outcomes?                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        | Applies to                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        | EO                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        | HEO                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        | SEO                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        | G6                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                        | SCS                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                              | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                       | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Has little knowledge of how digital, data and AI can change the way teams work, but notices when technology makes tasks easier or faster and shows curiosity about how transformation happens. | Understands that digital, data and AI can make work more efficient, fair and effective, and can describe in simple terms how technology has improved services or ways of working. | Understands how digital, data and AI approaches can be applied to improve everyday work and service delivery, including common opportunities and barriers to adoption. | Has detailed knowledge of how to plan and deliver technology-enabled change, including how to balance innovation, risk, efficiency and public value. | Holds authoritative understanding of how digital, data and AI transformation works at a strategic level, including how to build long-term capability and align technology adoption with organisational priorities. |

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| Skills Collaborative Working Continuous Learning                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| How would you rate your competence in encouraging and supporting colleagues to adopt digital, data and AI approaches in your work?                     |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | EO                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | HEO                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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|                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | G7                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | G6                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                            | SCS                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                         | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Follows instructions to use digital tools and systems that support change, and begins to notice opportunities where technology could improve outcomes. | Uses digital tools in own work and shares ideas for small improvements. Recognises how technology can make work more efficient and seeks guidance on how to contribute to adoption. | Applies digital, data and AI approaches to improve everyday work and contributes ideas for innovation. Helps colleagues try new tools responsibly and shares examples of how technology improves outcomes. | Plans and delivers technology-enabled change that balances innovation, efficiency and public value. Leads adoption initiatives, coaches colleagues and builds team confidence in new ways of working. | Sets the vision for digital, data and AI adoption across teams. Ensures technology-enabled change drives efficiency and aligns with organisational priorities, building long-term capability and confidence. |



Digital domain

| <div>BehavioursDigital WellbeingSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in helping colleagues feel confident about digital change - including when they are uncertain or sceptical?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO<div>G7G6SCS</div></div> |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                             | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                     | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                       | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Begins to notice when colleagues feel uncertain about new technology and asks questions about how to help them feel more confident.                                                                                                                                   | Recognises that people respond differently to digital change and supports colleagues by sharing simple, positive examples of technology improving work. | Addresses concerns about new technology openly and honestly. Shares evidence of benefits and helps colleagues build confidence through practical experience and peer support. | Actively manages resistance to digital change by understanding its causes and adapting approaches to build trust. Creates opportunities for colleagues to develop confidence in new ways of working. | Models and promotes a culture where digital change is approached with curiosity and confidence. Ensures teams feel supported through transformation and that trust is built and maintained at every stage. |

# Data domain

Working responsibly with data — from everyday literacy and quality through analysis, evidence-based decisions and sharing.

## Data literacy

7 questions

Foundational Data Skills

Builds the foundational understanding, skills and behaviours needed to work confidently and responsibly with data, recognising that evidence-based decisions lead to better outcomes.

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knowledge                                                                      |                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                     |                                                                  |                                                                                            |
| How would you rate your understanding of data and its role in decision-making? |                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                       | AA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS                                                                      |
| 1 Novice                                                                       | 2 Awareness                                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                   | 5 Expert                                                                                   |
| Basic or minimal knowledge of what data is or how it supports decisions.       | Understands what data is, how it is created and stored, and why evidence-based decisions lead to better outcomes. | Confidently understands core data concepts and how data flows through systems to support decisions. | Deep understanding of data as a tool to support decision-making. | Authoritative knowledge of data concepts and strategy; shapes data knowledge across teams. |

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Skills                                                                                                 |                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                          |                                                                                                  |
| How would you rate your competence in using data in your day-to-day work?                              |                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                               | Applies to                                                                                               | AA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS                                                                            |
| 1 Novice                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                     | 4 Practitioner                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                         |
| Finds and retrieves simple data with direct support, such as locating a record or looking up a figure. | Uses basic data independently to complete simple tasks such as updating a record or checking totals. | Uses data confidently and consistently in routine work; compares figures, checks accuracy and applies agreed ways of working. | Manages data across multiple tools; sets up shared spaces, models good practice and supports colleagues. | Leads how data is used across teams; designs consistent ways of working and drives improvements. |



Data domain

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Skills                                                                                               |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                             |
| How would you rate your competence in using the data tools and systems relevant to your role?        |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                             | Applies to AA/AO EO HEO SEO G7 G6 SCS                                                                       |
| 1 Novice                                                                                             | 2 Awareness                                                                                                      | 3 Working                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                    |
| Has little or no experience using data tools. Needs step-by-step instruction for the simplest tasks. | Can follow instructions to complete basic tasks in familiar tools, such as opening a report or entering a value. | Uses standard tools and systems independently to complete routine tasks such as updating records, running reports or checking totals. | Works confidently across multiple tools and systems, combining data sources and adapting to new tools with limited support. | Masters a wide range of tools and evaluates new ones. Advises others on the best tools for a given purpose. |

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| Skills Systems Thinking                                                                                                    |                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                               |
| How would you rate your competence in drawing on data rather than instinct or assumption when you need to make a decision? |                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                       | Applies to AA/AO EO HEO SEO G7 G6 SCS                                                                                         |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                   | 2 Awareness                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                                               | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                      |
| Does not yet use data to inform decisions independently. Follows instructions to find or check figures.                    | Uses simple data to help make basic decisions, such as checking a figure before sending a report. | Applies data regularly to support decisions in own work; draws straightforward conclusions and shares findings clearly. | Uses data to make well-reasoned recommendations and challenge assumptions; helps teams make evidence-based decisions. | Shapes how data informs decisions at a strategic level; champions evidence-based thinking and builds capability across teams. |

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Behaviours Ethical Practice                                                                                           |                                                                                        |                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                               |
| How would you rate your competence in making sure the data you work with and share is handled safely and responsibly? |                                                                                        |                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      | Applies to AA/AO EO HEO SEO G7 G6 SCS                                                                         |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                              | 2 Awareness                                                                            | 3 Working                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                       | 5 Expert                                                                                                      |
| Not yet aware of responsibilities around data handling. May make mistakes without realising the risk.                 | Understands that data must be handled carefully and follows basic rules when reminded. | Consistently follows data handling rules, protects sensitive information and raises concerns when something seems wrong. | Models careful and responsible data use, proactively identifies risks and ensures the team follows secure practices. | Champions responsible data use at a strategic level, leads on compliance and embeds a culture of data ethics. |

Data domain

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                          |                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>BehavioursContinuous LearningSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in evaluating and improving the data processes you work with?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                          |                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                               |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                              | 3 Working                                                                                               | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                      |
| Does not yet evaluate data processes. Works within whatever is in place.                                                                                                                                        | Notices when something could work better and mentions it, even if not yet taking action. | Takes steps to improve own data practices, applies lessons learned and shares what works with the team. | Identifies systemic issues and drives practical improvements, working with others to raise standards across the team. | Sets the strategic direction for data improvement, influences policy and governance and leads change that has lasting impact. |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                        |                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>BehavioursSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in questioning the data you use - for example, where it came from, how it was collected, or whether it tells the full story?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                        |                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                 |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                            | 3 Working                                                                                                     | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                 | 5 Expert                                                                                                        |
| Accepts data at face value. Does not yet question sources, methods or representativeness.                                                                                                                                                                   | Begins to ask basic questions about data - where it came from, whether it looks right - when prompted. | Routinely checks data for obvious issues such as missing values, outliers or inconsistencies before using it. | Critically evaluates data quality, bias and limitations; challenges poor data use and helps colleagues develop similar habits. | Shapes a culture of critical data evaluation across teams; sets standards for what counts as reliable evidence. |

Data domain

Interpreting visual data 4 questions

Foundational Data Skills

Reads charts, graphs and other visual representations of data to extract meaning, identify patterns and support clear communication of evidence.

|                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                           |                                                                                              |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knowledge                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                           |                                                                                              |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                       |
| How would you rate your understanding of visual data - including how charts and tables work, and how visual formats can help or mislead? |                                                                                                           |                                                                                              | Applies to                                                                                                                   | AA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS                                                                                                                 |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                 | 2 Awareness                                                                                               | 3 Working                                                                                    | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                               | 5 Expert                                                                                                                              |
| Little knowledge of what visual data is or why it is used. May not yet know how to read a chart independently.                           | Understands that charts and graphs present data visually to make patterns easier to spot and communicate. | Understands a range of common chart types, when to use them and how to read them accurately. | Understands how design choices in visualisations can help or hinder accurate interpretation; knows when visuals can mislead. | Authoritative knowledge of data visualisation principles; shapes how data is presented to ensure clarity, accuracy and accessibility. |

|                                                                                                                           |                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Skills                                                                                                                    |                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                  |
| How would you rate your competence in reading and extracting meaning from charts and tables?                              |                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                  | Applies to                                                                                                                             | AA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS                                                                                                            |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                  | 2 Awareness                                                                            | 3 Working                                                                                                                        | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                         | 5 Expert                                                                                                                         |
| Can identify basic features of a chart such as a title or axis label but needs support to understand what the data shows. | Reads simple charts and tables with guidance; identifies key figures and basic trends. | Reads and interprets a range of charts and tables independently; spots patterns, checks accuracy and draws relevant conclusions. | Interprets complex or unfamiliar visualisations confidently; identifies limitations, questions assumptions and draws nuanced insights. | Analyses and evaluates visualisations critically; identifies when data is being misrepresented and advises on better approaches. |

Data domain

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                              |                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                      |
| How would you rate your competence in creating clear and effective visualisations?              |                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                   | Applies to                                                                                                                            | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                              |
| 1 Novice                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                     | 3 Working                                                                                                         | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                             |
| Does not yet create visualisations independently. Needs guidance to produce even simple charts. | Creates basic charts using standard tools when shown what to do; follows templates or examples. | Produces clear, appropriately labelled visualisations that communicate the main finding to the intended audience. | Designs visualisations that are accurate, accessible and tailored to the audience; advises colleagues on how to present data clearly. | Sets standards for how data is visualised across teams; ensures visualisations are clear, accurate and accessible for all audiences. |

|                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                    |
| How would you rate your competence in considering whether the visual data you create or share works for people with different needs, including those using assistive technologies? |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                                                                                                      | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                            |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                           | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                     | 3 Working                                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                  | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                           |
| Not yet aware that visual data may be inaccessible to some people. Does not consider this when reading or creating charts.                                                         | Understands that some people find certain visual formats difficult to use; begins to consider this when creating simple charts. | Checks that visualisations are accessible - for example, not relying on colour alone - and considers whether the format works for all likely users. | Ensures accessibility and inclusion are built into how data is visualised across a team; reviews others' work and raises issues constructively. | Champions accessible and inclusive data visualisation; sets standards and ensures all visual outputs across teams meet accessibility requirements. |

Data domain

Managing data lifecycles5 questions

Foundational Data Skills

Handles data responsibly through each stage of its lifecycle - from collection and storage through to sharing, retention and disposal - following good practice to keep data secure, accurate and useful.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>KnowledgeSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate your understanding of how data moves through its lifecycle from collection to disposal - including what happens at each stage and why responsible handling throughout matters?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                        |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                  | 3 Working                                                                                                   | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                   | 5 Expert                                                                                                                               |
| Little knowledge of data lifecycle stages. May not be aware that data has a lifecycle at all.                                                                                                                                                                                                | Understands that data has a lifecycle - it is collected, stored, used and eventually disposed of - and that each stage has responsibilities. | Understands the key stages of the data lifecycle and the good practice principles that apply at each stage. | Understands how data lifecycle management affects data quality, security and compliance across a team or system. | Authoritative knowledge of data lifecycle management; shapes policy and practice to ensure data is handled responsibly at every stage. |

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in collecting and recording data correctly?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                            |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                   | 3 Working                                                                                                               | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                   |
| Collects or records data with direct support, following step-by-step instructions.                                                                     | Follows agreed procedures to collect and record data correctly, such as using the right format or completing required fields. | Collects and records data consistently and accurately; follows standards and flags issues when data doesn't look right. | Reviews and improves data collection processes; ensures data is recorded consistently and to a high standard across a team. | Designs data collection processes that are accurate, efficient and compliant; sets standards across teams. |

Data domain

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                 |                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                 |
| How would you rate your competence in storing and sharing data securely?                                      |                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                       | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>              |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                        |
| Needs support to store or share data securely. May not be aware of the risks of unsecured storage or sharing. | Follows basic rules for storing and sharing data - such as using approved systems and not sharing sensitive data without permission. | Stores and shares data securely and consistently, following agreed protocols and checking permissions before sharing. | Reviews how data is stored and shared across a team; identifies risks and puts improvements in place. | Sets standards for secure data storage and sharing across teams; ensures policies are practical, compliant and well understood. |

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                        |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                       |
| How would you rate your competence in disposing of data correctly?                   |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                |                                                                                                                  | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>    |
| 1 Novice                                                                             | 2 Awareness                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                      | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                   | 5 Expert                                                                                                              |
| Not yet aware of data disposal requirements. Does not yet act on them independently. | Understands that data must be disposed of correctly and follows instructions to delete or archive data when told to. | Disposes of data correctly and on time, following retention schedules and disposal procedures. | Ensures data disposal is managed consistently across a team; reviews retention schedules and addresses backlogs. | Sets and oversees data disposal standards; ensures retention policies are legally compliant and consistently applied. |

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| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                  |
| How would you rate your competence in making sure data is handled consistently and responsibly when it crosses team or organisational boundaries? |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                       | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                               |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                          | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                        | 3 Working                                                                                                                                 | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                         |
| Handles data in isolation. Not yet aware of how own data handling connects to or affects other teams.                                             | Begins to understand that data handling decisions can affect other teams; raises questions when unsure how own actions fit into the wider picture. | Considers how own data handling connects to other teams' work; flags issues that could affect shared data and follows up to resolve them. | Actively coordinates data handling across teams; ensures consistency, resolves cross-team issues and builds shared understanding of responsibilities. | Shapes how data handling is coordinated across the organisation; builds systems and relationships that ensure data flows reliably and responsibly between teams. |



Data domain

Ensuring data quality

3 questions

Data Quality and Integrity

Reviews and improves data to ensure they are accurate, representative and fit for purpose, helping teams to make reliable decisions and maintain trust in information.

|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knowledge                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| How would you rate your understanding of data quality and why it matters for decisions and outcomes?                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | EO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | HEO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | SEO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | G7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | G6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | SCS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                            | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Has no working knowledge of data quality. Begins to notice that some data seem more reliable than others and asks questions about why that matters. | Understands that data quality affects how reliable decisions and services are. Knows that quality can be assessed across dimensions such as accuracy, completeness and consistency, and can explain in simple terms why poor quality data causes problems. | Has sound knowledge of data quality principles and dimensions, and understands that quality is about fitness for purpose - whether data is good enough for the decision or task at hand. Familiar with government guidance on data quality and how it applies in their context. | Has detailed knowledge of data quality including how it interacts with the data lifecycle. Understands how quality issues compound across systems and teams, and knows that communicating quality transparently to the people using data is as important as improving it. | Has authoritative knowledge of data quality principles, dimensions and practices. Understands the importance of treating root causes rather than symptoms, anticipating how changes to systems or processes will affect quality, and driving a culture of continuous improvement at an organisational level. |

Data domain

| <div>Skills</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in identifying, correcting and cleaning data to ensure it is accurate and complete?</div> <div>Applies to<div>AA/AO</div><div>EO</div><div>HEO</div><div>SEO</div><div>G7</div><div>G6</div><div>SCS</div></div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Cannot yet identify or correct data errors independently. With support, begins to notice when something looks wrong, such as a missing entry or an obviously incorrect figure.                                                                                             | Identifies common errors in simple datasets with guidance, such as duplicates, missing values or figures that don't add up. Makes straightforward corrections when shown how, and reports issues that are beyond their ability to fix independently. | Applies routine checks to identify errors, inaccuracies and gaps in data within their area of work. Corrects and cleans data following agreed processes, documents what was changed and why, and escalates issues that require more specialist attention. | Reviews data systematically across a project or team, identifying patterns of error rather than isolated problems. Leads data cleaning activities, distinguishes between surface errors and deeper quality issues, and helps colleagues develop their ability to spot and correct problems. | Sets standards for how data errors are identified, corrected and documented across teams. Ensures checking and cleaning are built into processes rather than bolted on afterwards, and promotes a culture where quality problems are surfaced and treated at source. |

| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in assessing whether data are representative and unbiased?</div> <div>Applies to<div>AA/AO</div><div>EO</div><div>HEO</div><div>SEO</div><div>G7</div><div>G6</div><div>SCS</div></div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Cannot yet assess representativeness or bias independently. Begins to understand that data does not always reflect the full picture and asks questions about who or what might be missing.                                                                                    | Understands that data can be incomplete or skewed in ways that affect decisions. With guidance, begins to ask basic questions about where data came from, who collected it and whether important groups might be missing or underrepresented. | Applies straightforward checks to assess whether data are representative and free from obvious bias. Recognises that the choice of summary measure matters - for example, that a mean can mislead when data are skewed - and flags concerns about how data are being interpreted or used. | Systematically reviews data for representativeness and bias across projects, using evidence to challenge assumptions about what the data shows. Considers whether data collection and sampling methods are sufficient for the conclusions being drawn, and helps colleagues avoid common statistical pitfalls. | Sets standards for how representativeness and bias are assessed across teams. Ensures that data collection and management processes actively account for potential bias, and promotes a culture where the limitations of data are honestly acknowledged and communicated. |



Data domain

Handling data ethically and lawfully 3 questions

Data Quality and Integrity

Collects, uses and shares data fairly, securely and in line with laws and ethical principles, recognising that legal compliance is the minimum standard and that ethical obligations go further.

| <div>KnowledgeSystems ThinkingEthical Practice</div> <div>How would you rate your understanding of the legal and ethical framework governing how data should be collected, used and shared?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Has no working knowledge of data law or ethics. Begins to understand that there are rules governing how data can be used and that breaking them can harm people and organisations.                                                           | Understands that data use is governed by law and ethical principles, and is aware of key legislation such as data protection law. Knows in simple terms what this means for everyday work - for example, that personal data must be kept secure and only shared appropriately. | Has sound working knowledge of the legal and ethical framework governing data use, including data protection legislation and relevant government guidance. Understands that acting lawfully is the minimum requirement, not the standard to aim for, and knows when to seek advice from specialists such as data protection officers. | Has detailed knowledge of the legal and ethical framework, including how different pieces of legislation interact and how ethical principles apply in complex or ambiguous situations. Recognises that something can be legal but still ethically wrong, and can help colleagues navigate that distinction. | Has authoritative knowledge of the legal and ethical framework governing data use across government. Understands how legislation, policy and ethical standards interact at a strategic level, and actively promotes a culture where ethical data use goes beyond mere compliance. |

Data domain

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| How would you rate your competence in checking that data you access, use or share is handled lawfully and ethically?                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Cannot yet make independent judgements about whether data can be accessed, used or shared appropriately. With support, follows clear instructions to handle data safely, such as using secure storage or not sharing files without permission. | Follows established guidance when accessing, using and sharing data. Checks before sharing personal or sensitive data, uses approved channels and asks for help when unsure whether something is appropriate. | Applies legal and ethical requirements confidently in everyday work when accessing, using and sharing data. Uses established tools and processes - such as data sharing agreements or impact assessments - to check that data use is appropriate, and raises concerns when something doesn't feel right. | Reviews how data is being accessed, used and shared across a project or team, applying appropriate tools and frameworks to assure both compliance and ethical standards. Identifies gaps or inconsistencies, helps colleagues navigate less straightforward situations and ensures practice goes beyond legal minimum. | Sets standards for lawful and ethical data access, use and sharing across teams. Ensures that established assurance tools and frameworks are used consistently, that legal compliance is treated as a baseline rather than a destination, and builds a culture where ethical considerations are part of every decision involving data. |

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| How would you rate your competence in identifying and responding to legal and ethical risks or violations in how data is used?                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Cannot yet identify data risks or violations independently. With support, begins to recognise situations where something might have gone wrong, such as data being shared with the wrong person, and knows to tell someone. | Recognises common data risks and violations with guidance, such as unauthorised sharing or use of data for an unintended purpose. Knows who to report concerns to and follows clear steps when something goes wrong. | Identifies legal and ethical risks in everyday data use and responds appropriately - escalating violations, following incident procedures and helping to limit any harm caused. Understands the difference between a legal breach and an ethical concern that falls short of breaking the law. | Reviews data use across a project or team to proactively identify legal and ethical risks before they become violations. Leads the response when problems occur, ensures lessons are learned and helps colleagues develop their ability to spot and respond to risks. | Sets standards for how legal and ethical risks are identified, assessed and responded to across teams. Ensures that risk identification is proactive rather than reactive, and promotes a culture where concerns are raised early and violations are treated as opportunities to improve rather than just incidents to manage. |

Data domain

Applying data standards 2 questions

Data Quality and Integrity

Uses agreed rules and formats to keep data consistent and interoperable, supporting effective data use, openness and collaboration across the Civil Service.

| <div>KnowledgeSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate your understanding of data standards and why consistency and interoperability matter across government?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Has no working knowledge of data standards. Begins to understand that data needs to be consistent to be useful and asks questions about why agreed rules and formats matter.                                          | Understands that data standards are agreed rules and formats that make data consistent and easier to share across teams and systems. Knows in simple terms why inconsistent data causes problems - for example, that different date formats or naming conventions make data difficult to combine or compare. | Has sound working knowledge of data standards and why they matter for consistency and interoperability across government. Understands how applying standards in their own work contributes to data being usable beyond their immediate team or system. | Has detailed knowledge of data standards including how they interact with data sharing and open data requirements. Understands how standards enable systems to exchange data automatically and can make the case for consistent adoption to colleagues and stakeholders. | Has authoritative knowledge of data standards frameworks and their strategic importance for interoperability across government. Understands how schemas, APIs and related technical standards connect to wider data infrastructure and policy goals, and can guide teams through complex decisions about standards adoption and development. |

Data domain

| <div><div>Skills</div><div>Collaborative Working</div></div> <div>How would you rate your competence in applying agreed data standards in your own work and flagging when data doesn't meet them?</div> <div>Applies to<div>AA/AO</div><div>EO</div><div>HEO</div><div>SEO</div><div>G7</div><div>G6</div><div>SCS</div></div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Cannot yet apply data standards independently. With support, begins to follow simple rules for recording information, such as entering dates in a required format or using an approved list of categories.                                                                                                                     | Follows agreed rules for recording and submitting information, such as using required formats, approved codes or consistent naming conventions. Recognises that doing this makes data easier to use and compare across teams, and asks for help when unsure which format or category to use. | Applies agreed rules and formats consistently and independently when recording, submitting or sharing data. Checks own data before sharing, corrects simple inconsistencies and flags issues that require more specialist attention. | Applies data standards confidently across varied situations and checks that data meets agreed standards across a project or team. Spots and addresses inconsistencies, helps colleagues understand why standards matter and supports more consistent adoption. Contributes to decisions about how standards should be applied or updated in their context, including in relation to open data requirements. | Sets and maintains data standards across teams, ensuring consistent adoption and identifying where existing standards need updating or where new ones are needed. Provides guidance and training, engages with cross-government standards work including open data requirements, and ensures teams understand how their data connects to wider government data infrastructure. |

Data domain

Analysing data 4 questions

Data-Driven Decision Making

Uses data and analytical tools and techniques to find patterns, draw insights and support evidence-based decisions that improve outcomes.

| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| How would you rate your understanding of data analysis and how it supports decision-making - including what kinds of questions it can answer and what its limitations are?                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | EOHEOSEOG7G6SCS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Has minimal knowledge of data analysis but begins to understand that examining data carefully leads to better decisions. Recognises simple analytical outputs such as totals or averages with support. | Understands that data analysis involves examining information to find patterns, differences or trends that support decisions. Knows that different analytical approaches suit different questions and that outputs need to be checked for accuracy. | Has sound knowledge of core analytical concepts and methods. Understands how analysis connects to decision-making, including the importance of checking assumptions and being honest about what the data does and does not show. | Has detailed knowledge of analytical methods and tools, including when to use different approaches and when to involve specialist analytical colleagues. Understands the implications of analytical choices for the quality and reliability of conclusions. | Has authoritative knowledge of data analysis including advanced methods, the analytical landscape across government and the strategic value of robust analysis for policy and service delivery. Shapes how analytical capability is understood and built across teams. |

| Skills                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How would you rate your competence in using analytical tools and software to work with data?                               |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                     | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                                                                          | EOHEOSEOG7G6SCS                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                   | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                            | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Uses simple tools such as spreadsheets with direct support to review small amounts of data; follows step-by-step guidance. | Uses basic analytical tools reliably with light support; sorts, filters and compares data to identify simple patterns and differences. | Uses analytical tools confidently and independently, including spreadsheet features such as pivot tables and charts; checks outputs for accuracy and knows when results look wrong. | Recognises when more advanced tools - such as data visualisation software or statistical packages - would better serve the analysis; can use or commission them and coaches colleagues on tool choice and use. | Understands the landscape of analytical tools including automated and machine learning approaches; guides decisions about when and how to use them and sets standards for tool use across teams. |

Data domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| How would you rate your competence in working out what question you need to answer and finding the right data to answer it?               |                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                         | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                         | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                  | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                        | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                               | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Cannot yet identify independently what data would help answer a question. With support, begins to understand what is being asked and why. | Identifies what data might help answer a simple question with guidance, such as what needs to be compared or measured. Asks for help when unsure whether the right data are available or suitable. | Works out what question needs answering and identifies appropriate data to answer it. Checks that data are relevant, sufficient and suitable before beginning analysis. | Breaks complex or ambiguous questions into manageable parts and identifies the data needed at each stage. Helps colleagues sharpen their questions and challenges assumptions about what data will and won't show. | Shapes how questions are framed across teams, ensuring analysis starts from a clear question rather than available data. Sets standards for how data needs are scoped and documented. |

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| How would you rate your competence in communicating analytical findings, including uncertainty and limitations?            |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                   | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                              | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Cannot yet communicate analytical findings independently. With support, begins to describe what data show in simple terms. | Shares simple findings with guidance, such as summarising a key figure or trend. Begins to recognise that findings have limitations and flags uncertainty when prompted. | Communicates findings clearly to colleagues, explaining what the data show and what they don't. Acknowledges limitations and uncertainty honestly rather than overstating what the analysis proves. | Presents findings to varied audiences, adapting language and format to suit the context. Clearly articulates confidence levels, caveats and the implications of analytical limitations for decisions. | Sets standards for how analytical findings are communicated across teams, ensuring uncertainty and limitations are consistently and honestly reported. Builds a culture where caveats strengthen rather than undermine analytical credibility. |



Data domain

Collaborating with data 4 questions

Responsible Data Sharing

Works with other teams and organisations to share and reuse data safely and ethically, helping to create collaborative insight, efficiency and improvement.

| <div>KnowledgeSystems ThinkingEthical Practice</div> <div>How would you rate your understanding of data sharing across teams and organisations, including what enables it and what governs it?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Has no working knowledge of data sharing across teams. Begins to understand that data can be shared beyond their immediate team and asks questions about what makes that possible and what the rules are.                                       | Understands that data sharing across teams and organisations is governed by rules and agreements, and that it requires both technical and legal conditions to be met. Knows in simple terms why sharing data can improve outcomes and why those rules exist to protect people and organisations. | Has sound working knowledge of what enables and governs data sharing across teams and organisations, including relevant legal frameworks, data sharing agreements and good practice guidance. Understands that both over-caution and careless sharing can cause harm, and knows when to seek advice. | Has detailed knowledge of the legal, technical and organisational conditions that enable effective data sharing. Understands how data sharing agreements, access controls and governance frameworks work in practice, and can identify and address barriers that prevent teams from sharing data effectively and responsibly. | Has authoritative knowledge of data sharing frameworks, standards and governance across government. Understands how legal, technical and cultural factors interact to enable or block data sharing, and can guide teams and organisations through complex or sensitive data sharing decisions. |

Data domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| How would you rate your competence in sharing data with other teams and organisations safely, lawfully and effectively?                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                     | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Cannot yet share data with other teams independently. With support, follows clear instructions to share approved files or information using agreed channels. | Shares data with other teams using approved channels and following established guidance. Begins to understand that how data is shared matters as well as whether it is shared - for example, that a spreadsheet is more useful to recipients than a screenshot. Asks for help when unsure about permissions or formats. | Shares data with other teams and organisations safely and lawfully, following agreed processes and using appropriate tools and agreements. Chooses formats that recipients can actually work with rather than just formats that are convenient to send, and raises concerns when requests feel unclear or inappropriate. | Leads data sharing activities across projects, ensuring the right legal, technical and governance conditions are met. Helps colleagues navigate sharing requests confidently, addresses barriers that prevent legitimate sharing and ensures data is shared in formats that colleagues and partners can readily work with. | Sets standards for how data is shared across teams and organisations, ensuring processes are safe, lawful and as frictionless as possible. Identifies systemic barriers to sharing and works across organisational boundaries to remove them, promoting a culture where responsible sharing in useful, reusable formats is the default rather than the exception. |

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| How would you rate your competence in finding, accessing and reusing data that others have shared?                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Cannot yet find or access shared data independently. With support, begins to understand that data collected by others may already exist and could be useful for their work. | Finds and accesses shared data using approved channels and following established guidance. Begins to think about what data might already exist before collecting new data, and asks colleagues who might hold relevant information. | Finds, accesses and reuses data that others have shared, checking that use is lawful and appropriate. Proactively considers what data might help answer a question and who across their organisation might already hold it, rather than defaulting to collecting new data. | Identifies opportunities to reuse data across projects, thinking creatively about which teams or organisations might hold relevant data and brokering connections to make it accessible. Helps colleagues develop the habit of looking for existing data before collecting new data. | Promotes a culture where finding and reusing shared data is the default starting point. Works creatively across organisational boundaries to surface data that teams didn't know existed, reduces duplication across government and makes data more findable and accessible for others. |



Data domain

| <div>BehavioursSystems ThinkingCollaborative Working</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in working with others to make data sharing across your organisation easier and more consistent?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Begins to notice when data sharing between teams is slow or blocked and asks questions about why. Follows clear instructions to support simple data sharing tasks.                                                                                   | Understands that effective data sharing depends on relationships and trust as much as rules and processes. Begins to build connections with colleagues in other teams and asks questions about what data they hold and how it might be shared. | Actively builds working relationships that make data sharing easier and more effective. Approaches data sharing requests with an enabling mindset, looking for ways to share responsibly rather than reasons to refuse, and encourages colleagues to do the same. | Builds and maintains relationships across teams and organisations that enable regular, effective data sharing. Challenges a culture of unnecessary caution or restriction, helps colleagues develop confidence in sharing responsibly and models an enabling approach in their own practice. | Shapes the culture around data sharing across teams and organisations, making responsible openness the default rather than the exception. Builds networks and partnerships that unlock data sharing at scale, and champions the value of collaborative data use for improving outcomes and public value. |

# Innovation domain

How people and teams improve how work is done — creating conditions for ideas, understanding problems, testing approaches and making change stick.

## Psychological safety and adaptability

5 questions

Conditions for Innovation

Creates the conditions for colleagues to share ideas, try new approaches and learn from failure, building a team environment where experimentation and honest reflection are normal.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| How would you rate your understanding of how people respond to uncertainty and change at work, and why that affects whether innovation happens?                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | EO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | HEO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | SEO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | G7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | G6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | SCS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Has no formal knowledge of how people respond to uncertainty and change. Begins to notice that some people and teams seem more comfortable with risk and new ideas than others, and is curious about what makes that difference. | Understands that people's responses to change and uncertainty are shaped by their environment as much as their personality - and that fear of judgement, blame or instability can stop good ideas from surfacing. Recognises that this applies to themselves as well as others. | Understands the psychological and organisational mechanisms that shape how people respond to change and risk - including why people resist new ideas, how change affects motivation and confidence, and what conditions make experimentation feel safe. Can connect this understanding to what they observe in their own team. | Has detailed knowledge of research and frameworks relating to psychological safety, change management and resilience - including how leadership behaviour, organisational culture and workload affect people's capacity to adapt and innovate. Uses this knowledge to diagnose why a team or environment is or isn't conducive to innovation. | Holds authoritative understanding of the organisational psychology underpinning both psychological safety and adaptability to change. Draws on research and evidence to advise on how to build environments where people can cope with uncertainty and take creative risks sustainably - and understands how these conditions connect to broader organisational culture and innovation capability. |

Innovation domain

| <div>Skills</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| How would you rate your competence in identifying what it takes to get a new idea off the ground - who needs convincing, what concerns to address, and how to frame the proposal?                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Has no experience building a case for new ideas. Begins to notice that proposals need more than a good idea behind them and asks questions about what makes some cases more persuasive than others. | Understands that getting support for new approaches requires identifying who needs to be involved, what their concerns might be and how to address them. With guidance, begins to think about how to frame a proposal and who the right people to approach might be. | Applies straightforward techniques to build a case for new ideas - identifying key stakeholders, anticipating objections and framing proposals in terms of benefits and manageable risk. Knows how to find a sponsor for a small-scale experiment and how to present evidence clearly to support a proposal. | Applies a systematic approach to making the case for innovation - mapping stakeholders, understanding their priorities and risk concerns, and tailoring proposals accordingly. Coaches colleagues on how to frame ideas persuasively and helps them identify the right routes to seek support. | Has deep knowledge of how organisational decision-making works and what it takes to build lasting support for innovation. Advises others on influencing strategies, helps teams develop strong proposals, and contributes to building organisational processes that make it easier to get new ideas heard and evaluated fairly. |

| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Digital Wellbeing</div>                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| How would you rate your effectiveness in making it feel safe for colleagues to share ideas, try new things and admit when things go wrong?                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Has no established practice here. Begins to notice how others respond to new ideas and mistakes, and reflects on how their own reactions might affect whether colleagues feel comfortable speaking up. | Responds openly and constructively when colleagues share ideas or admit mistakes, and avoids reactions that might discourage people from speaking up. Recognises that their own behaviour - however junior their role - contributes to how safe others feel to take creative risks. | Consistently models behaviours that signal it is safe to experiment and fail - responding to unsuccessful attempts with curiosity rather than blame, actively inviting dissenting views and acknowledging their own uncertainties and mistakes. Encourages colleagues to share early-stage ideas before they are fully formed. | Actively works to build a team environment where experimentation is expected and failure is treated as a source of learning rather than a cause for blame. Addresses behaviours that chill creative risk-taking, makes space in team processes for reflection on what didn't work, and helps colleagues reframe unsuccessful experiments constructively. | Shapes team and organisational culture so that psychological safety is a structural feature, not dependent on individual personalities or relationships. Establishes norms, processes and leadership expectations that sustain a culture of honest experimentation, and helps other leaders understand their role in building and protecting it. |

Innovation domain

Behaviours

Continuous Learning

How would you rate your effectiveness in responding when an experiment or new idea doesn't work out - in your own work and when it happens to colleagues?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
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| Has little experience of how to respond constructively when things go wrong. Begins to notice their own reactions to failure - in their own work and others' - and reflects on whether those reactions help or hinder learning. | Understands that how people respond to failure shapes whether others feel safe to experiment. Tries to respond to their own mistakes and others' with openness rather than defensiveness, and recognises when a reaction - including their own - might discourage future risk-taking. | Responds to unsuccessful experiments - their own and colleagues' - with curiosity and a focus on learning rather than blame. Asks what can be learned rather than what went wrong, and helps colleagues extract useful insight from things that didn't work out as planned. | Models a consistently constructive response to failure and helps teams develop shared practices for reflecting on and learning from experiments that don't succeed. Recognises the difference between productive failure - where learning occurred - and avoidable failure, and helps teams make that distinction without blame. | Shapes how failure is understood and treated across teams, ensuring that learning from unsuccessful experiments is built into ways of working rather than left to individual goodwill. Helps leaders understand their own role in modelling healthy responses to failure and the long-term cost of cultures where mistakes are hidden. |

Behaviours

Digital Wellbeing

How would you rate your competence in coping with change at work and supporting colleagues who are finding it hard?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| Has little experience of managing their own response to significant change at work. Begins to notice how change affects their motivation and ways of working, and asks for support when feeling uncertain or overwhelmed. | Maintains basic effectiveness when facing change, with support. Recognises when change is affecting their own or colleagues' confidence and asks questions about how to adjust. Begins to develop personal strategies for staying productive when processes, tools or priorities shift. | Adapts their own working practices when facing change, maintaining effectiveness without significant loss of productivity. Supports colleagues by sharing what helps them adjust, normalising uncertainty as a feature of innovative environments and encouraging others not to let discomfort with change prevent them from trying new things. | Maintains effectiveness and supports colleagues through sustained or rapid change, helping teams stay productive and psychologically safe even when direction is unclear. Recognises the cumulative toll of continuous change and takes practical steps to protect team wellbeing and capacity to innovate under pressure. | Builds team-wide adaptability as a sustained capability rather than a response to individual change events. Helps leaders understand the relationship between change management, psychological safety and innovation capacity, and ensures teams have the support, structures and culture to keep innovating even in conditions of significant uncertainty. |

Innovation domain

Identifying innovation opportunities 5 questions

Understanding the Problem

Spots where innovation is most likely to make a real difference, using evidence and user insight to distinguish genuine opportunities from novelty for its own sake.

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| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| How would you rate your understanding of where innovation is most likely to make a real difference - and what makes something a genuine opportunity rather than change for its own sake?                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Has little formal knowledge of what innovation means in a public sector context. Begins to notice when processes feel unnecessarily slow or complicated and is curious about whether things could be done differently. | Understands that innovation means finding better ways to deliver services or outcomes - not just adopting new technology. Recognises that genuine opportunities for improvement often come from user needs, inefficient processes or unmet demands, and that not every problem requires an innovative solution. | Understands how to distinguish genuine innovation opportunities from change for its own sake. Knows that the strongest opportunities tend to cluster around persistent user pain points, processes that haven't kept pace with available technology, and places where evidence consistently points to poor outcomes. | Has detailed understanding of how to assess the landscape for innovation opportunities - including how to read data, user research and organisational context to identify where change would deliver the greatest value. Understands the difference between incremental improvement and step-change innovation, and when each is appropriate. | Holds authoritative understanding of where and how innovation creates sustainable public value - including the systemic conditions that enable or suppress it, how innovation opportunity landscapes shift over time, and how to build organisational knowledge that continuously surfaces high-value opportunities. |

Innovation domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| How would you rate your competence in using evidence to identify where innovation or improvement is most needed - and assess whether an opportunity is realistic and worth pursuing?                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Has no established practice of identifying or evaluating opportunities for improvement. Begins to notice when something could work better and asks questions about what makes an opportunity worth acting on. | Uses simple evidence sources with guidance - such as feedback, complaints data or observation - to spot where something isn't working well. With guidance, begins to think through whether an opportunity is realistic, considering whether there is a clear problem, whether users would benefit and whether it is broadly achievable. | Applies straightforward methods to identify and assess innovation opportunities. Draws on data, user feedback and process observation to build an evidence-based case for where improvement is needed, and weighs likely impact against feasibility, resource requirements and risk. Presents a clear, honest assessment of whether an opportunity is worth pursuing. | Systematically combines multiple evidence sources to identify high-value opportunities and makes confident, well-reasoned judgments about whether they are worth pursuing. Considers public sector specific constraints - policy alignment, risk appetite, procurement requirements - alongside impact and feasibility. Helps colleagues develop more rigorous approaches to both finding and evaluating opportunities. | Designs and embeds approaches across teams for continuously scanning evidence and evaluating opportunities in a consistent, transparent way. Builds shared criteria for assessing where innovation effort should be focused and advises senior leaders on prioritisation decisions, ensuring the organisation develops a mature, honest approach to identifying and acting on the most valuable opportunities. |



Innovation domain

| <div>BehavioursSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate how consistently you think about what users actually experience when deciding where innovation or improvement is most needed?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Has little habit of thinking about what users actually experience. Begins to notice when services seem designed around internal processes rather than user needs, and asks questions about how that could be different.                      | Begins to consider what users actually experience when thinking about where things could be improved. Recognises that the most valuable opportunities for innovation often come from genuine user pain points rather than internal priorities, and seeks out simple ways to understand what users find difficult. | Consistently draws on understanding of user experience when identifying where innovation is needed - going beyond what data shows to consider what it feels like to use a service. Brings user perspectives into team discussions about improvement and challenges proposals that aren't grounded in genuine user need. | Habitually anchors innovation thinking in deep understanding of user experience, actively seeking out direct contact with users and ensuring that opportunity identification across projects is driven by what users actually need rather than what is internally convenient. Coaches colleagues to develop the same habit. | Shapes a team culture where user experience is the primary lens through which innovation opportunities are identified and evaluated. Ensures that direct user insight - not just data or assumption - informs decisions about where to focus innovation effort, and challenges organisational tendencies to innovate around internal convenience rather than genuine user need. |

Innovation domain

| <div>BehavioursContinuous Learning</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in constructively challenging established ways of working when you think something could be done better?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div>                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Notices when processes or ways of working seem unnecessarily complicated or slow, but has little confidence in raising this. Begins to ask questions - at least privately - about why things are done a particular way and whether there might be a better approach. | Asks constructive questions about why things are done a particular way, with support. Recognises that challenging established practices respectfully is a valuable contribution, not a source of disruption, and begins to share observations about processes that could work better. | Constructively challenges established ways of working when there is a good reason to - raising questions, sharing evidence and suggesting alternatives in ways that are honest and respectful. Does not accept 'we've always done it this way' as a sufficient justification, and encourages colleagues to think critically about processes they take for granted. | Actively and consistently challenges assumptions about how work is done, bringing evidence and user insight to bear on why existing approaches may no longer be fit for purpose. Creates space in team discussions for honest questioning of established practice, and helps colleagues develop the confidence and skills to do the same. | Builds a team culture where constructive challenge of the status quo is expected and valued - not tolerated as an exception. Models intellectual honesty about what isn't working, helps leaders understand the cost of unchallenged assumptions, and ensures that questioning established practice is treated as a sign of engagement rather than a source of risk. |



Innovation domain

| <div>BehavioursSystems Thinking</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in seeking out connections between your work and what's happening elsewhere - in other teams, disciplines or sectors - to inform where and how you innovate?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Begins to notice connections between their own work and how similar challenges are faced or approached elsewhere - in other teams, services or sectors. Shows curiosity about different contexts and asks questions about what could be learned from them.                                  | Actively looks beyond their immediate team for ideas, approaches and shared challenges that might be relevant to their own work. Spots patterns across different areas - noticing when a problem they're facing resembles something encountered elsewhere - and shares these observations with colleagues. | Deliberately seeks out perspectives from outside their immediate context - other teams, disciplines or sectors - and brings what they learn back into how they identify and frame innovation opportunities. Helps colleagues make connections between their work and ideas from elsewhere, encouraging cross-pollination of thinking. | Builds and maintains relationships across organisational and sectoral boundaries that bring a regular flow of fresh perspectives and ideas into their team. Creates informal and structured opportunities for colleagues to encounter thinking from outside their immediate context, and ensures that cross-boundary insight informs how the team identifies and pursues innovation opportunities. | Cultivates networks, partnerships and team conditions that systematically surface transformative ideas over the long term. Ensures that the organisation maintains meaningful connections with external communities of practice, other sectors and international peers, and builds a culture where curiosity about how others solve problems is a recognised and valued source of innovation opportunity. |

Innovation domain

Using the innovation lifecycle1 question

Doing the Work

Applies the stages of the innovation lifecycle - from identifying a problem through to testing, refining and deciding whether to scale, stop or adapt - with appropriate rigour at each stage.

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| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                      |
| How would you rate your understanding of the stages of the innovation lifecycle, from identifying a problem through to testing, refining and deciding whether to stop or scale a solution? |                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                      | Applies to                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                      |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2 Awareness                                                                                                            | 3 Working                                                                                            | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                         | 5 Expert                                                                                                                             |
| Has little or no practical knowledge of the stages of the innovation lifecycle.                                                                                                            | Understands that innovation moves through distinct stages, from problem to solution, and can name them in broad terms. | Understands the stages of the innovation lifecycle and can explain how they apply to their own work. | Has detailed understanding of the lifecycle including why moving between stages in response to evidence matters; helps colleagues in their area of work apply it well. | Holds authoritative knowledge of the lifecycle across contexts; shapes how the lifecycle is taught, applied or governed more widely. |

Testing and prototyping3 questions

Doing the Work

Tries out ideas on a small scale first, using prototypes, pilots and minimum viable products to learn quickly and reduce risk before committing to larger investment.

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| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                               |
| How would you rate your understanding of what makes a test or prototype genuinely useful, such as a minimum viable product designed to test critical assumptions, before committing to a solution fully? |                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                            | Applies to                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                               |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                 | 3 Working                                                                                                                  | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                         | 5 Expert                                                                                                                      |
| Has little or no practical knowledge of what makes a test or prototype useful.                                                                                                                           | Understands that testing an idea before committing fully reduces risk, without yet knowing what makes a test well designed. | Understands what makes a test or prototype useful, including testing critical assumptions before committing to a solution. | Has detailed understanding of designing tests that isolate and check critical assumptions; helps colleagues in their area of work design better tests. | Holds authoritative knowledge of test and prototype design; shapes standards or practice for how testing is done more widely. |

Innovation domain

Skills

Continuous Learning

How would you rate your competence in trying out new ideas on a small scale first - learning from what happens before committing to them fully?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| Has no experience of testing or prototyping ideas. Begins to understand why trying a small version of something before committing to it fully makes sense, and is curious about how this works in practice. | Participates in testing and prototyping activities when asked - such as giving feedback on a draft process, trying out a new approach and reporting what happened, or helping gather observations during a pilot. Understands that the purpose is to learn quickly rather than to produce something finished, and begins to think about what would need to be true for a test to be useful. | Applies straightforward methods to design and run simple experiments and build basic prototypes. Defines what the test needs to find out, chooses an approach that generates useful learning without over-investing in something unproven, and interprets evidence from the test to decide whether to refine, pivot or stop. | Designs and leads testing and prototyping activities that generate reliable learning efficiently. Selects appropriate methods based on what needs to be learned and the resources available, and ensures tests are designed to surface genuine insight rather than confirm existing assumptions. Helps colleagues develop more rigorous and imaginative approaches to testing and iteration. | Sets standards for how testing and prototyping are conducted across teams, ensuring experiments are well designed, ethically sound and genuinely iterative rather than performative. Builds team capability in lean experimentation and helps leaders understand how to create the governance and approval conditions that make rapid, low-cost testing possible in a public sector context. |

Innovation domain

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| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div> <div>Continuous Learning</div>                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| How would you rate how consistently you reflect on what worked and what didn't when you try something new or test an idea - and share what you found with others who might benefit?                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Has little habit of reflecting on what worked or didn't when trying something new. Begins to notice when an approach hasn't worked as expected and asks questions about what could be done differently next time. | Reflects on the outcomes of tests or new approaches they have participated in - noting what worked, what didn't and what they would do differently. Shares observations with immediate colleagues and recognises that what they learned could be useful to others facing similar challenges. | Systematically uses what they learn from testing to shape next steps - adjusting their approach, feeding findings back into a process or proposal, and deciding whether to refine, try something different or stop. Shares learning with colleagues in a way that is accessible and useful, rather than just reporting what happened. | Ensures that learning from testing is captured, shared and actively used to inform decisions across projects. Creates simple structures for reflecting on and documenting what was learned, and helps colleagues develop the habit of treating every test - successful or not - as a source of useful insight. Challenges the tendency to move on without extracting the full learning value from an experiment. | Builds team culture and processes that ensure learning from testing travels - across projects, teams and organisational boundaries - rather than staying with the individuals who ran the test. Establishes norms for knowledge sharing and reflection that make iterative learning a sustained organisational capability rather than a one-off activity. |

Innovation domain

Storytelling and advocacy 2 questions

Doing the Work

Communicates ideas for change in a way that genuinely persuades different audiences, framing evidence and impact so that decision-makers, colleagues and users understand why it matters.

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| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| How would you rate your understanding of how to communicate an idea for change in a way that genuinely persuades different audiences?                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                              | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Has little formal knowledge of how to communicate ideas for change. Begins to notice that some people are more persuasive than others and is curious about what makes the difference. | Understands that communicating an idea for change requires more than explaining it clearly - it requires connecting it to what the audience cares about and addressing their concerns. Recognises that different audiences need to hear things differently and that evidence alone rarely persuades. | Understands the principles behind effective change communication - including how to structure a compelling narrative, how to connect an idea to outcomes that matter to different audiences, and why emotional resonance alongside evidence is important for building genuine support rather than passive compliance. | Has detailed knowledge of change communication theory and practice - including how to tailor messages for different stakeholders, how to anticipate and address resistance, and how to sustain engagement over the course of a change initiative rather than just at the point of launch. | Holds authoritative understanding of what makes change narratives work at an organisational level - including the research on persuasion, motivation and behaviour change that underpins effective advocacy. Uses this knowledge to advise others on communication strategy and to build organisational capability in change communication. |

Innovation domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| How would you rate your competence in tailoring your communication of ideas for change to different audiences, framing them in ways that connect to outcomes people genuinely care about?                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Has little experience of communicating ideas for change to different audiences. Begins to notice that the same explanation doesn't always land the same way with different people, and asks questions about how to frame ideas more effectively. | Explains ideas for improvement simply and clearly with guidance, adjusting basic language and emphasis for different audiences. Begins to think about what different audiences care about and tries to connect the idea to outcomes that are relevant to them, seeking feedback on whether the message has landed. | Adapts how they communicate ideas for change depending on the audience - adjusting language, emphasis and framing to connect the proposal to outcomes that matter to that audience. Structures explanations as a coherent narrative rather than a list of features, making clear what will change, why it matters and what it means for the people involved. | Constructs compelling narratives around proposed changes that resonate with varied audiences - from frontline colleagues to senior leaders - connecting the idea clearly to outcomes they genuinely value. Anticipates concerns and addresses them within the narrative rather than as afterthoughts, and helps colleagues develop their own ability to communicate change persuasively. | Sets standards for how change narratives are constructed and communicated across teams, ensuring they are consistently honest, audience-appropriate and connected to outcomes that matter. Builds team capability in persuasive change communication and models the kind of narrative craft that generates genuine understanding and lasting commitment rather than superficial agreement. |



Innovation domain

Continuous improvement

3 questions

Making Change Stick

Treats improvement as an ongoing habit, regularly reviewing how work is done and making evidence-based changes to processes, services and outcomes.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| How would you rate your understanding of structured approaches to continuous improvement - the principles, methods and tools that help teams regularly review and improve how they work?                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Has no formal knowledge of continuous improvement approaches. Begins to notice when processes feel unnecessarily slow or wasteful and is curious about whether there are structured ways to make them better. | Understands that continuous improvement means regularly reviewing how work is done and making evidence-based adjustments - rather than waiting for things to go wrong before changing them. Recognises that small, frequent improvements often deliver more lasting value than large one-off changes. | Understands the principles behind structured improvement approaches - including how to identify waste and inefficiency, how to use data and feedback to diagnose problems, and how to implement and monitor changes in a systematic way. Familiar with common improvement frameworks used in the public sector and can apply their underlying logic to everyday work. | Has detailed knowledge of continuous improvement methodologies - such as Lean, Plan-Do-Study-Act and Kaizen - and understands their relative strengths and limitations in a public sector context. Can advise colleagues on which approaches suit different types of problems and how to adapt improvement methods to work within organisational constraints. | Holds authoritative understanding of continuous improvement theory and practice - including how improvement methodologies connect to broader organisational learning, culture change and service transformation. Advises on how to build lasting improvement capability across teams and helps leaders understand the systemic conditions that enable or undermine continuous improvement at scale. |

Innovation domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div> <div>Continuous Learning</div>                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| How would you rate your competence in implementing improvements deliberately and measuring whether they have had the effect you intended - rather than making changes and hoping for the best?                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Has little experience of implementing changes deliberately or checking whether they have worked. Begins to notice that changes sometimes don't have the effect people expected, and asks questions about how to tell whether something has actually improved. | Makes simple changes to how they work with guidance, and checks informally whether they have made a difference - such as asking colleagues whether a new approach feels better or tracking whether a recurring problem has reduced. Recognises that checking the impact of a change is as important as making it. | Implements changes in a planned way - defining what success looks like before making the change, monitoring what happens afterwards and adjusting if the change hasn't had the intended effect. Distinguishes between changes that have genuinely improved outcomes and those that have simply changed how work feels without making a measurable difference. | Leads improvement implementation across projects - ensuring changes are well planned, impact is measured rigorously and findings are used to refine further. Challenges changes that haven't been properly evaluated and helps colleagues develop more disciplined approaches to implementing and measuring improvement. | Sets standards for how improvements are implemented and evaluated across teams - ensuring that impact measurement is built into how change is managed rather than treated as an afterthought. Builds team capability in evidence-driven improvement and helps leaders understand the difference between activity and genuine, measurable progress. |



Innovation domain

| <div>BehavioursContinuous Learning</div> <div>How would you rate how consistently you treat improvement as an ongoing habit - regularly reviewing how work is going and keeping that focus alive in your team even when other pressures mount?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7 G6 SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Has no established habit of regularly reviewing how work is going. Begins to notice when the same problems keep recurring and is curious about how teams maintain a focus on improvement over time rather than just fixing things when they break.                                                | Regularly reflects on how their own work is going - noticing what's working well, what keeps going wrong and what small changes might help. Shares observations with colleagues and encourages others to do the same, recognising that improvement works best when it is a shared habit rather than an individual activity. | Consistently makes time to review how work is going - individually and with colleagues - and treats improvement as a regular part of how they work rather than an occasional project. Keeps momentum going by celebrating small improvements, acknowledging what has been learned from changes that didn't work, and encouraging colleagues to keep looking for ways to do things better. | Actively builds a team environment where continuous improvement is a shared expectation rather than an individual initiative - creating regular spaces for reflection, making it easy for colleagues to flag problems and suggest changes, and ensuring that improvement doesn't lose momentum when immediate pressures mount. | Embeds continuous improvement as a sustained cultural feature across teams - ensuring it is built into how work is planned, reviewed and celebrated rather than dependent on individual champions. Helps leaders understand the conditions that sustain an improvement culture over time and the signals that indicate it is starting to erode. |

Innovation domain

Embedding innovation at scale 4 questions

Making Change Stick

Supports the adoption and spread of new approaches beyond a pilot or team, sustaining commitment and adapting what worked locally so it works more widely.

Knowledge

How would you rate your understanding of what makes it hard to spread a successful idea or new way of working more widely - and what helps overcome those challenges?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| Has no formal knowledge of what scaling an innovation involves. Begins to notice that things which work well in one team or context don't always work the same way elsewhere, and is curious about why that happens. | Understands that scaling an innovation is harder than it might appear - that what works in a pilot doesn't automatically transfer to a wider context, and that successful adoption requires planning, communication and sustained support rather than simply rolling something out. Recognises that people's readiness and capacity to adopt change varies and that this affects how scaling needs to be managed. | Understands the key factors that determine whether an innovation scales successfully - including the importance of stakeholder buy-in, clear communication, adequate resource and support, and the need to adapt an approach for different contexts rather than assuming a one-size-fits-all rollout will work. Familiar with why innovations often stall between pilot and full adoption and what can be done to address this. | Has detailed knowledge of how to plan and manage the scaling of innovations in complex organisations - including implementation science principles, how to sequence adoption across different teams or contexts, and how to identify and address the organisational, cultural and practical barriers that prevent successful scaling. Can advise colleagues on what good scaling looks like and what the common failure points are. | Holds authoritative understanding of what makes innovation travel successfully across complex public sector organisations - including the systemic conditions, leadership behaviours and governance arrangements that enable or undermine scaling. Draws on theory and evidence to advise on scaling strategy and helps leaders understand why innovations that work at pilot stage so often fail to achieve lasting widespread adoption. |

Innovation domain

| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in actively supporting the adoption of new approaches - at whatever level your role allows, from helping a colleague understand a change to planning how it reaches different teams?</div> <div>Applies to<div>AA/AO</div><div>EO</div><div>HEO</div><div>SEO</div><div>G7</div><div>G6</div><div>SCS</div></div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Has no experience of helping spread a new approach beyond their immediate work. Begins to notice when colleagues are finding a change difficult to adopt and asks questions about what support would help them.                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Supports the adoption of new approaches in their immediate context - helping colleagues understand what is changing and why, flagging where something isn't landing well and passing feedback to those leading the rollout. Recognises that successful adoption requires ongoing support rather than a single communication or training event. | Contributes actively to scaling efforts - adapting how a new approach is explained or implemented for different audiences and contexts, identifying where barriers to adoption are emerging and suggesting practical ways to address them. Keeps those leading the rollout informed of what is and isn't working on the ground. | Plans and manages the adoption of new approaches across teams or services - sequencing rollout thoughtfully, anticipating resistance and capacity constraints, and designing support that helps people genuinely embed a change rather than just comply with it. Addresses barriers proactively and adjusts the approach when adoption isn't progressing as intended. | Sets standards for how innovation is scaled across teams - ensuring rollout is planned, supported and evaluated in a way that leads to genuine embedding rather than superficial compliance. Builds organisational capability in managing adoption and helps leaders understand the human and cultural dimensions of scaling that determine whether an innovation sticks or fades. |

Innovation domain

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |            |  |       |    |     |     |    |    |     |
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| Behaviours                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Continuous Learning                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |            |  |       |    |     |     |    |    |     |
| How would you rate your competence in supporting and championing change to help maintain momentum - even when the initial excitement fades?                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Applies to |  | AA/AO | EO | HEO | SEO | G7 | G6 | SCS |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |            |  |       |    |     |     |    |    |     |
| Has little experience of sustaining commitment to a change over time. Begins to notice when enthusiasm for a new approach fades and people drift back to old habits, and is curious about what keeps some changes alive while others don't stick. | Continues to use and advocate for new approaches even when initial enthusiasm has faded and it would be easier to revert to old habits. Recognises that their own visible commitment to a change - however junior their role - signals to colleagues that it is worth persisting with. | Actively keeps momentum alive around changes they are involved in - checking in with colleagues on how adoption is going, acknowledging difficulties honestly, celebrating small wins and continuing to make the case for why the change matters even when other pressures make it tempting to let it slide. | Anticipates the point at which energy around a change typically fades and takes deliberate steps to sustain commitment - refreshing communication, reconnecting people to the reasons for the change, addressing emerging fatigue and ensuring that early adopters feel supported and recognised. Helps colleagues understand that the difficult middle period of a change is normal and manageable. | Builds organisational conditions that sustain commitment to change over the long term - ensuring that new approaches are embedded in processes, incentives and expectations rather than dependent on individual enthusiasm. Helps leaders understand the dynamics of change fatigue and the signals that indicate a change is starting to erode, and intervenes early to prevent drift back to old habits. |            |  |       |    |     |     |    |    |     |

Innovation domain

| <div>BehavioursCollaborative Working</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in actively connecting with colleagues in other teams, departments or organisations - sharing what has worked and helping proven approaches reach people who could benefit from them?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7 G6 SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Has little experience of building relationships beyond their immediate team. Begins to notice that good ideas often spread through personal connections rather than formal processes, and is open to sharing what they have learned with colleagues in other teams when the opportunity arises.                             | Shares what their team has tried and learned with colleagues outside their immediate context, and is receptive to hearing what others are doing differently. Recognises that building relationships across organisational boundaries makes it easier for successful approaches to spread, and looks for informal opportunities to make those connections. | Actively builds relationships with colleagues in other teams and organisations who are working on similar challenges - sharing what has worked, learning from their experience and making connections that help proven approaches travel beyond their original context. Represents their team's work externally and helps others understand what they have learned and how it might apply elsewhere. | Deliberately cultivates partnerships across organisational boundaries that enable successful innovations to spread - identifying who needs to know about a proven approach, brokering connections between teams with relevant experience and ensuring that knowledge about what works doesn't stay siloed. Builds relationships with external organisations, other government departments and professional networks that keep their team connected to the wider innovation landscape. | Builds and sustains cross-organisational partnerships and networks that systematically enable innovation to travel across government - ensuring that proven approaches reach the teams and contexts where they could deliver the greatest value. Establishes lasting relationships with external partners, other departments and international peers that create ongoing channels for shared learning and collaborative innovation at scale. |

# AI domain

Using and governing artificial intelligence responsibly — including machine learning, automation, classification, recommendation and generative AI.

## AI literacy

4 questions

Foundational AI Skills

Builds foundational understanding of what AI is, how it works and what it can and cannot do across machine learning, automation and generative AI, and develops the practical skills needed to specify inputs, use tools effectively and work critically with outputs in everyday work.

Knowledge

How would you rate your understanding of what AI is, how it works and what it can and cannot do?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                            | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| Basic or minimal knowledge; knows that AI tools exist and are used in government but has little understanding of how they work or what they can do. | Understands what common AI tools do and broadly how they work; knows that AI outputs depend on inputs such as training data and that different AI approaches (e.g. prediction, classification, generative text) suit different tasks. | Confidently understands how different AI types generate outputs, what their limitations are, and what failure modes mean for how outputs should be used - including hallucination and bias for generative systems, and false positives/negatives, drift and overfitting for prediction and classification systems. | Deep understanding of AI capabilities and limitations across different types including generative AI, predictive models, classification, recommendation and automation; advises colleagues on appropriate use and potential harms. | Authoritative knowledge of the AI landscape; shapes how AI is understood and used responsibly across teams and stays current with developments in AI capabilities and risks. |

Skills

How would you rate your competence in using AI tools in your everyday work?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                              | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                 | 3 Working                                                                                                                                             | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                    | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                            |
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| Uses AI tools with direct support; needs guidance on which tools are appropriate and how to use them for basic tasks. | Uses familiar AI tools independently for simple, everyday tasks; knows which approved tools are available and follows organisational guidance on their use. | Uses a range of AI tools confidently and independently in own work; selects the right tool for the task and applies AI where it genuinely adds value. | Uses AI tools fluently across varied contexts; helps colleagues identify and adopt tools that improve their work and shares practical knowledge of effective use. | Sets the standard for effective AI tool use across teams; ensures colleagues have the skills and confidence to use AI tools well and stays current with new tools and capabilities. |



AI domain

| <div>SkillsContinuous Learning</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in specifying and preparing inputs so AI systems produce reliable, useful outputs?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Follows basic guidance on inputs - such as example prompts or provided reference data - with support; needs help understanding why inputs affect output quality.                                                 | Prepares simple inputs independently - for example clear prompts with purpose and audience, or appropriate reference data - and understands that input quality shapes results. | Specifies effective inputs for a range of everyday AI uses; for generative tools, frames prompts neutrally and iterates when outputs miss the mark; for other systems, recognises when training data, thresholds or context need checking; confirms outputs address the task before use. | Develops and shares effective input practices across AI types and contexts; coaches colleagues on clear specification and neutral framing where bias could be introduced; troubleshoots poor outputs by revisiting inputs and configuration. | Sets standards for how teams specify and validate inputs across AI systems; stays current with evolving practice; ensures colleagues understand how leading inputs or poor reference data can compromise high-stakes work such as policy advice. |

| <div>BehavioursEthical Practice</div> <div>How would you rate your competence in checking whether an AI output is reliable before acting on it or sharing it with others?</div> <div>Applies toAA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS</div> |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                          |
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| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                               | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                            | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Beginning to notice that AI outputs might not always be right; tends to accept what AI produces without applying own judgment.                                                                                             | Recognises that AI outputs can be wrong or misleading; approaches them with some caution and seeks guidance before acting on outputs that seem uncertain. | Consistently approaches AI outputs critically; questions what AI produces, considers limitations and does not use outputs without applying own judgment. | Models critical engagement with AI outputs; challenges colleagues who accept AI outputs uncritically and promotes a questioning approach across the team. | Champions a culture of critical AI literacy across teams; ensures that questioning AI outputs is treated as standard practice rather than optional, especially in high-stakes decisions. |

AI domain

Assessing AI opportunities

3 questions

Foundational AI Skills

Identifies where AI and automation could add genuine value, and recognises the limitations and risks that could make AI unsuitable.

|                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| Knowledge                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| How would you rate your understanding of where AI and automation can and cannot add value - including what kinds of tasks AI tends to help with and what makes some tasks unsuitable? |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                               | AA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                              | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                   | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Basic or minimal knowledge; knows that AI can improve some processes but has little understanding of where it adds value or why it might not be suitable.                             | Understands the types of tasks and processes where AI is most likely to add value; knows that suitability depends on factors like data quality, process stability and the nature of the task. | Confidently understands where AI and automation can and cannot add value across a range of task types; knows what makes a task well-suited to AI and what constraints - technical, ethical or practical - might make it unsuitable. | Deep understanding of the conditions under which AI delivers genuine value; advises on where AI investment is likely to be worthwhile and where it is not, drawing on evidence and experience across different contexts. | Authoritative knowledge of AI opportunity and constraint across the full range of AI types; shapes how AI potential is assessed across teams and ensures adoption is evidence-based and proportionate. |

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SkillsContinuous LearningSystems Thinking                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| How would you rate your competence in identifying tasks, inefficiencies or pain points that AI could help address?                                               |                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                              | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                 | AA/AOEOHEOSEO G7G6SCS                                                                                                                                                                |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                         | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                             | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Begins to notice that some tasks might benefit from AI; tends toward an all-or-nothing view of what AI can do rather than seeing specific opportunities clearly. | Identifies simple opportunities where AI could reduce repetitive work or improve efficiency; shares ideas with colleagues and is open to exploring what might be possible. | Actively identifies tasks, inefficiencies and pain points in own work and service processes where AI could add genuine value; develops initial ideas and engages others to test assumptions. | Leads structured identification of AI opportunities across a team or area of work; uses evidence and insight to pinpoint where AI could have the highest impact and builds a credible case for investment. | Shapes how AI opportunities are identified across teams; builds the culture, networks and frameworks needed to surface transformative ideas and turn them into lasting improvements. |



AI domain

|                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Skills</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| How would you rate your competence in weighing up whether AI is the right solution for a problem, taking into account its limitations and risks alongside its potential benefits?                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                 |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Aware that AI has some limitations but may not yet understand what they are; tends to either dismiss AI entirely or accept it uncritically rather than identifying specific risks or constraints. | Recognises common constraints that affect AI suitability such as poor data quality, unstable processes or regulatory requirements; follows guidance to weigh these against potential benefits. | Confidently identifies limitations and risks that could make AI unsuitable for a given task - including data gaps, ethical concerns, high-stakes decisions and tasks requiring human judgment; uses this to make well-rounded recommendations. | Anticipates complex constraints including ethical implications, change impact and long-term risk; helps colleagues recognise limitations they may have missed and ensures proposals are realistic and responsible. | Ensures AI is only adopted where limitations have been thoroughly assessed and mitigated; shapes how risk and constraint evaluation is done across teams and aligns adoption with strategy, ethics and regulation. |

Using AI safely3 questions

Foundational AI Skills

Uses AI tools and automation safely in everyday work - knowing which tools are approved, what data can be shared with them, spotting when a prompt or task carries risk, and escalating when something feels wrong.

|                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                |                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Knowledge</div>                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                |                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                      |
| How would you rate your understanding of your organisation's rules on which AI tools are approved for use and what data can safely be shared with them? |                                                                                                |                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                           | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                   |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                | 2 Awareness                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                 | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                            | 5 Expert                                                                                                                             |
| Has little or no practical knowledge of which AI tools are approved or what data can safely be shared with them.                                        | Understands that rules exist on approved tools and data sharing, and knows where to find them. | Understands which tools are approved for their own work and what data can and cannot be shared with them. | Has detailed understanding of the reasoning behind approval and data-sharing rules; explains them to colleagues and flags situations the guidance does not clearly cover. | Holds authoritative knowledge of approval and data-handling rules across tools and contexts; shapes or advises on the policy itself. |

AI domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>How would you rate your competence in spotting when a specific AI prompt or task carries a safety risk - whether from the data it contains or from the nature of the task itself - and adjusting or stopping before proceeding?</b> |                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                    | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                            |
| <b>1 Novice</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>2 Awareness</b>                                                                                                                        | <b>3 Working</b>                                                                                                                                   | <b>4 Practitioner</b>                                                                                                                                              | <b>5 Expert</b>                                                                                                                               |
| Cannot yet reliably spot when a prompt or task carries a safety risk without direct support; with support, begins to avoid obviously sensitive data in prompts.                                                                        | Uses basic checks with support to recognise common data risks in prompts; relies on others to judge whether a task itself is appropriate. | Applies safety checks independently in routine situations, spotting both data exposure and tasks unsuited to AI, and adjusts or stops accordingly. | Uses judgement independently across varied scenarios to spot subtler risks that are not obviously about data; helps colleagues in their area of work see them too. | Leads application of safety judgement across teams or services in novel or ambiguous situations; shapes guidance or standards others rely on. |

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                       |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>How would you rate your ability to escalate concerns about AI use to the right person when something feels wrong?</b> |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                      | Applies to <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                          |
| <b>1 Novice</b>                                                                                                          | <b>2 Awareness</b>                                                                                                                | <b>3 Working</b>                                                                                            | <b>4 Practitioner</b>                                                                                                                | <b>5 Expert</b>                                                                                                                             |
| Shows curiosity and asks questions when something feels wrong, but needs prompting to know what to do about it.          | Raises concerns with a manager or colleague when encouraged, with support when needed; may hesitate to act alone without support. | Escalates concerns about AI use consistently in everyday work, promptly and without needing to be prompted. | Coaches and supports others informally by spotting subtle or complex risks and escalating with enough detail for action to be taken. | Shapes standards by exercising authoritative judgement on when AI use crosses a line, including risks existing guidance does not yet cover. |

AI domain

Interpreting AI outputs 4 questions

AI Governance and Ethics

Develops the skills and behaviours needed to check, interpret and communicate AI outputs critically and honestly - maintaining human judgment and transparency rather than deferring uncritically to AI recommendations.

|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knowledge                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| How would you rate your understanding of how AI generates outputs and why they may be unreliable or biased? |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | EO                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | HEO                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | SEO                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | G7                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | G6                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | SCS                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Basic or minimal knowledge; knows that AI outputs can be wrong but may not understand why.                  | Understands that AI outputs can be inaccurate, uncertain or biased; knows that outputs are shaped by the data the system was trained on and that checking them is important for fair and transparent decisions. | Confidently understands why AI outputs may be unreliable - including hallucination, bias from training data, overconfidence and lack of context; knows how to recognise these issues and what they mean for how outputs should be used. | Deep understanding of how different AI types generate outputs, their specific failure modes and how patterns of error or bias can be identified and documented; the person others turn to when AI outputs need scrutinising. | Authoritative knowledge of AI output reliability, evaluation methods and documentation standards; shapes how outputs are reviewed, challenged and explained across teams and in high-stakes decisions. |

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| Skills                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Systems Thinking                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                           |
| How would you rate your competence in checking and interpreting AI outputs before acting on them?                       |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | Applies to                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | AA/AO                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | EO                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | HEO                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | SEO                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | G7                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | G6                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          | SCS                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                         | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                        | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Checks AI outputs with direct support; needs guidance to understand what an output means and whether it can be trusted. | Applies basic checks to AI outputs with light support; asks questions about how results were generated and avoids acting on them without verifying. | Checks and interprets AI outputs independently; compares them with other evidence, looks for errors or bias and applies consistent checks before acting. | Tests AI outputs rigorously across varied scenarios; identifies patterns of error or bias, suggests improvements and reviews colleagues interpretations for accuracy. | Sets standards for how AI outputs are checked and documented across teams; guides high-stakes decisions and ensures review processes are robust and consistently applied. |

AI domain

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| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                             |
| How would you rate your competence in making clear to others when a decision or recommendation has been informed by AI - including what that means for how certain you are? |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                   | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                           | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                     |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                    | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                         | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                       | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Beginning to notice that AI involvement in a decision or output is worth mentioning; does not yet do this consistently or know how to explain uncertainty.                  | Acknowledges when AI has contributed to a decision or recommendation and flags basic limitations to colleagues in plain terms. | Consistently transparent about AIs role in decisions and recommendations; clearly communicates uncertainty and limitations so others can make informed judgments. | Actively ensures AI contributions and their limitations are clearly communicated in all relevant contexts; challenges colleagues who present AI outputs without appropriate caveats. | Champions transparency about AI use and uncertainty across teams; sets standards for how AI contributions are disclosed and documented, including in high-stakes decisions. |

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| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| How would you rate your competence in deciding when to trust an AI output and when to question or override it?                 |                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                                                                                                                               | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                             |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                       | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                     | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Beginning to notice that AI outputs might not always be right; tends to accept what AI produces without applying own judgment. | Recognises the importance of human judgment alongside AI; avoids accepting recommendations blindly and asks questions before acting on outputs. | Consistently exercises own judgment when working with AI outputs; treats AI as one input among several rather than the final word, and overrides it when evidence or experience suggests otherwise. | Actively guards against automation bias in own and others work; coaches colleagues to apply independent judgment and challenges decisions that defer uncritically to AI. | Leads a culture of human oversight across teams; ensures AI is used as a tool to support judgment rather than replace it, particularly in high-stakes decisions affecting citizens. |

AI domain

Applying AI governance 3 questions

AI Governance and Ethics

Understands and applies the legal, regulatory and compliance frameworks that govern AI use in public services - including identifying and responding to governance risks.

Knowledge

Ethical Practice

How would you rate your understanding of the legal and regulatory frameworks that govern AI use?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                       | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                          | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Basic or minimal knowledge; knows that AI use is governed by rules and policies but has little understanding of what they are. | Understands the key legal and regulatory requirements that apply to AI use; knows where to find guidance and who to ask when unsure. | Confidently understands how relevant laws, regulations and organisational policies apply to AI use in own context; knows how governance frameworks connect to accountability and compliance, and recognises that rules are a minimum standard rather than the whole picture. | Deep understanding of AI governance frameworks, regulatory requirements and accountability structures; recognises when compliance alone is not enough and knows when to look beyond the rules. | Authoritative knowledge of AI law, regulation and governance; identifies gaps where existing frameworks have not kept pace with technology, advocates for stronger governance and shapes how frameworks are understood and applied across teams. |

Skills

Ethical Practice

How would you rate your competence in applying governance and compliance requirements when using or commissioning AI?

Applies to

AA/AO

EO

HEO

SEO

G7

G6

SCS

| 1 Novice                                                                                                                             | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                 | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                              | 5 Expert                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Follows agreed rules and policies when using AI tools with direct support; asks for help when unsure whether something is permitted. | Applies basic governance requirements reliably with light support; checks that AI use follows organisational policy and knows who to contact when requirements are unclear. | Applies relevant governance and compliance requirements confidently in everyday AI use; ensures AI tools and outputs meet organisational and regulatory standards before acting on them. | Leads compliance across a team or area of work; ensures AI use meets all relevant legal and regulatory requirements and coaches colleagues on their governance obligations. | Sets governance standards for AI use across teams; ensures compliance frameworks are practical, up to date and consistently applied. |

AI domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                              |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                            |
| How would you rate your competence in identifying and responding to governance and compliance risks in AI use?         |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                | Applies to                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                            |
|                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                  |                                                                                                                                                            |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                               | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                      | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                           | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                   |
| Recognises that some AI use may carry risks; flags concerns with a manager or appropriate contact with direct support. | Identifies obvious governance risks such as using unapproved tools or sharing data inappropriately; escalates promptly and follows guidance on how to respond. | Identifies and responds to governance risks in own AI use; applies agreed processes to mitigate risks and reports issues before they escalate. | Reviews AI use across a team or area of work for governance risks; leads responses to compliance issues and strengthens processes to prevent recurrence. | Shapes how governance risks are identified and managed across teams; ensures risk management processes are robust, proportionate and consistently applied. |

Using AI responsibly and ethically 5 questions

AI Governance and Ethics

Applies ethical principles to AI use in public services - including fairness, transparency to citizens, public benefit and consideration of wider societal and environmental impact - grounded in the Data and AI Ethics Framework and UK AI regulatory principles.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <div>Knowledge</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div>                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| How would you rate your understanding of the ethical principles that should guide responsible AI use in public services?                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Has little knowledge of the ethical principles that apply to AI in public services, but begins to notice situations where AI use might raise concerns about fairness, transparency or harm - including environmental cost. | Understands the key ethical principles that apply to AI - including fairness, transparency, avoiding harm to people and minimising environmental impact - and can recognise when they are relevant in simple situations. | Applies ethical principles confidently in everyday AI use. Understands how fairness, transparency, wider societal impact and environmental sustainability apply to the AI tools and approaches used in own work. | Applies detailed knowledge of ethical principles across a team or area of work; ensures AI use reflects fairness, transparency, accountability and environmental responsibility, and stays current with evolving guidance and legislation. | Authoritative knowledge of ethical principles for AI in public services; shapes how they are understood and applied across teams, advocates for stronger standards where needed, and stays current with evolving guidance and legislation - including emerging requirements on environmental sustainability. |



AI domain

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| How would you rate your competence in applying fairness and public benefit considerations when using or recommending AI?              |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                              | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                    | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                           | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Recognises that AI can produce unfair or biased outcomes but needs support to identify when this is happening or what to do about it. | Considers whether AI use is fair and likely to be beneficial; flags concerns when something seems discriminatory, harmful or contrary to the public interest, with guidance on how to respond. | Applies fairness and public benefit considerations to own AI use; identifies when AI may produce inequitable outcomes for different groups and raises this appropriately before decisions are made. | Leads fairness and public benefit assessments across a team or area of work; ensures AI use actively serves the public interest, addresses bias and considers impact on different groups including those who may be disadvantaged. | Shapes how fairness and public benefit are assessed and embedded across teams; ensures AI adoption is genuinely equitable, challenges use that fails to meet this standard, and advocates for those most at risk of harm. |

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| <div>Skills</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Collaborative Working</div>                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| How would you rate your competence in making AI use transparent and explainable to those affected by it?                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                         | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                        | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Recognises that people affected by AI decisions have a right to understand how those decisions were made; needs support to explain AI use to others in practice. | Understands why transparency with affected people matters; can explain AI use in simple, honest terms with light guidance and knows when to seek help for more complex situations. | Ensures people affected by AI-informed decisions in own work understand how AI was used and what it contributed; recognises that transparency about process and outcomes can and should be provided even where the technical detail of an AI system cannot be disclosed. | Ensures transparency and explainability are built into how AI is used and communicated across a team; helps colleagues explain AI use clearly to those affected, ensures people know how to raise concerns or challenge decisions, and understands which types of transparency are appropriate in which circumstances - including when technical transparency is not possible. | Sets standards for transparency and explainability in AI use across teams; ensures those affected by AI decisions can understand, question and challenge them through genuinely accessible routes, including in situations where full technical transparency is not possible for security or operational reasons - ensuring process and outcome transparency fill that gap. |

AI domain

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| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div>                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| How would you rate your ability to consider the wider and longer-term effects of using AI - including on people who won't be in the room when decisions are made? |                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                                          | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                              | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Beginning to notice that AI can affect people beyond those directly involved; does not yet consider this consistently or know how to act on it.                   | Considers the wider impact of AI use on people and communities, including those who may not have a say in how AI is used; raises concerns when impacts seem harmful or disproportionate. | Consistently considers the wider and longer-term impact of AI in own work - including on people who are affected but have no voice in the decision - and raises this proactively rather than waiting to be asked. | Actively ensures the impact of AI on people with no direct voice is considered across a team or area of work; builds this into how decisions are made, ensures environmental and societal consequences are part of the conversation, and challenges decisions that overlook these impacts. | Champions consideration of wider societal and environmental impact in AI use across teams; creates the conditions for those with no voice to be represented in decision-making, takes long-term consequences seriously and holds the organisation accountable for the broader effects of its AI use. |

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| <div>Behaviours</div> <div>Systems Thinking</div> <div>Ethical Practice</div> <div>Continuous Learning</div>                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| How would you rate your ability to factor in the environmental cost of AI when deciding whether and how to use it?                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Applies to                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <div>AA/AO</div> <div>EO</div> <div>HEO</div> <div>SEO</div> <div>G7</div> <div>G6</div> <div>SCS</div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 1 Novice                                                                                                                                            | 2 Awareness                                                                                                                                                                                     | 3 Working                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 4 Practitioner                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 5 Expert                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Not yet aware that AI tools have an environmental cost. Begins to notice when this is mentioned and asks questions about what it means in practice. | Understands that AI tools use significant energy and that choosing them proportionately is part of responsible use. Begins to consider whether AI is the right tool for a task before using it. | Consistently considers whether AI is the most proportionate tool for a task - for example, using a search engine rather than a generative AI tool for a simple factual query. Avoids unnecessary or repeated AI use when simpler alternatives work just as well. | Actively promotes proportionate AI use across a team or area of work. Reviews how AI tools are used, identifies patterns of unnecessary or wasteful use, and coaches colleagues to make more sustainable choices. Flags environmental considerations when AI adoption decisions are being made. | Embeds environmental sustainability into team expectations and standards for AI use. Ensures that guidance, training and procurement processes reflect the principle that AI should be used proportionately and that its resource costs are a legitimate factor in adoption decisions. Connects this to broader organisational commitments on sustainability. |